

UPSC Monthly Current Affairs — September 2026

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Exam digest: the 150 most exam-relevant of 753 notes this period, grouped by GS paper and subject.

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Most important

1. BRICS Summit Begins with Modi's Call for Global South Leadership, Adoption of Delhi Declaration · GS2
2. This weekend in Delhi, Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi hosted the Brics · GS2
3. India Launches EOS-05: First Imaging Satellite in Geosynchronous Orbit at 2:55 AM · GS3
4. Leaders of BRICS member states, including China and Russia along with Iran · GS2
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6. UPI hits merchants: New 0.4% fee on P2M transactions over ₹2,000 capped at ₹300 · GS3
7. At the Brics summit in Delhi, leaders from 11 nations including India · GS2
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9. After American forces resumed strikes against Iran, Iran launched missile and drone · GS2
10. Donald Trump Xi Jinping LIVE Updates: US-China Summit White House State Visit Key Announcements Trade AI Live News · GS2
11. The US Congress passed a bill giving President Donald Trump sweeping powers · GS2
12. Putin says BRICS contributes more than 40% of global GDP at forum · GS2
13. BRICS leaders gather as Delhi braces for train cancellations and Metro changes · GS2
14. The IAEA accused Iran of noncompliance with nuclear commitments, passing a resolution · GS2
15. Iran Claims Strike on US Vessel as Fighting Resumes in Strait of Hormuz · GS2

History & Culture

Ancient & medieval India · Prelims + Mains · 29 Sept

NCERT Replaces European Revolutions with Medieval India History in Class 9 Textbook

Why in news: NCERT released a new Class 9 Social Science textbook replacing European revolutions with Indian medieval resistance movements to emphasize indigenous history.

Key facts: The NCERT released the new textbook on September 29, 2026. It covers the period between 1,000 and 1,700 CE, focusing on the Sikh Gurus' persecution and the Jat Uprising of 1669.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** NCERT: National Council of Educational Research and Training is the apex body for school education curriculum in India
- **Fact:** Jat Uprising: A significant regional resistance movement occurred in 1669
- **Fact:** The new curriculum focuses on the period between 1,000 and 1,700 CE

Mains question: Discuss the significance of decolonizing the Indian school curriculum by shifting focus from Western revolutions to indigenous medieval resistance movements.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127859](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127859)

Heritage sites, UNESCO & GI tags · Prelims · 30 Sept

Five new sites, including Udaigiri Caves, added to India's UNESCO World Heritage tentative list

Why in news: The Government of India added five new sites, including the Udaigiri Caves and Satyagraha sites, to the UNESCO World Heritage tentative list.

Key facts: India now has a total of 78 sites on the UNESCO World Heritage tentative list. The new additions include Bagh Cave Paintings, Group of Temples of Chambal Valley, Ginnorgarh Fort, and a transnational proposal on Satyagraha sites.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** UNESCO: United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
- **Place:** Udaigiri Caves: Located in the state of Madhya Pradesh
- **Fact:** India's total tentative list count: 78 sites
- **Place:** Ginnorgarh Fort: Located in the state of Rajasthan

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the UNESCO World Heritage status in promoting cultural preservation and boosting heritage tourism in India.

Source: NDTV · [satyadheesh.in/news/128055](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128055)

Polity & Constitution

Judiciary & landmark judgments · Prelims + Mains · 15 Sept

Supreme Court launches "Jan Soochna Seva" for simplified Hindi legal bulletins on Hindi Diwas

Why in news: The Supreme Court launched 'Jan Soochna Seva' to provide simplified Hindi legal bulletins to make judicial outcomes more accessible to the general public.

Key facts: The initiative was launched on September 14, 2026, to coincide with Hindi Diwas. It provides simplified summaries and audio/video bulletins of significant judgments for litigants and persons with disabilities.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** Supreme Court of India: The highest judicial body in the country.
- **Fact:** Jan Soochna Seva: A public information service providing simplified legal summaries in Hindi.
- **Post:** Hindi Diwas: Celebrated annually on September 14th to promote the Hindi language.

Mains question: Discuss how the simplification of legal language and multi-lingual dissemination of judgments can enhance the 'Access to Justice' for marginalized sections of Indian society.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/121928](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/121928)

Federalism & Centre-State relations · Prelims + Mains · 17 Sept

Supreme Court Rejects Tamil Nadu's Petition on Navodaya Vidyalayas, Sets Three-Month Deadline

Why in news: The Supreme Court rejected Tamil Nadu's petition against the mandate to build Navodaya Vidyalayas in every district, emphasizing cooperative federalism in language policy.

Key facts: The Supreme Court rejected a petition by the Tamil Nadu government seeking to recall an interim order regarding land for Navodaya Vidyalayas. The court set a three-month deadline for the state to identify land and urged a shift in mindset regarding the inclusion of Hindi.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** Navodaya Vidyalayas are established by the Navodaya Vidyalaya Samiti under the Ministry of Education.
- **Place:** Tamil Nadu is a state in Southern India.
- **Fact:** The Supreme Court set a three-month deadline for the state to provide land for the schools.

Mains question: Discuss the importance of cooperative federalism in balancing linguistic diversity with national educational policies in India.

Source: NDTV · [satyadheesh.in/news/122797](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/122797)

Ladakh Leaders Withdraw Protest Plan Amid Progress In Talks With Centre

Why in news: The Ladakh leadership withdrew protests after the Centre agreed to discuss constitutional safeguards under Article 371 and a 'sui generis' governance model.

Key facts: The Leh Apex Body and Kargil Democratic Alliance are the primary political groups involved in the talks. The government is considering amendments to Article 371 to provide unique constitutional safeguards for the region.

Prelims pointers

- **Constitution:** Article 371 provides special provisions for various states in the Indian Union.
- **Fact:** Ladakh was carved out as a separate Union Territory from Jammu and Kashmir in 2019.
- **Place:** Kargil and Leh are the two primary districts of the Union Territory of Ladakh.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of 'sui generis' governance models in addressing the unique aspirations of Union Territories like Ladakh.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/123530

Supreme Court wants law to safeguard multi-crore court deposits

Why in news: The Supreme Court highlighted the need for a standardized law to manage litigants' court deposits to prevent inconsistent interest rates and post-judgment litigation.

Key facts: The Supreme Court (Justices P.S. Narasimha and Alok Aradhe) suggested a unified scheme for court deposits. It directed the Law Commission of India to study international precedents, specifically the U.S. Court Registry Investment System (CRIS) model.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** Law Commission of India: A non-statutory body that advises the government on legal reforms.
- **S&T:** CRIS (Court Registry Investment System): A U.S. model where court deposits are pooled into a unified investment scheme.
- **Fact:** Current issue: Inconsistent rules across different courts lead to varying interest rates on deposited funds.

Mains question: Discuss the need for a standardized legal framework for managing court deposits to ensure transparency and judicial efficiency in India.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/124365

Should Chief Election Commissioner, Election Commissioners Appointments Be Referred To Larger Constitution Bench, Supreme Court Split

Why in news: The Supreme Court split on whether to refer a petition challenging the 2023 law regarding the appointment process of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and Election Commissioners (ECs) to a larger bench.

Key facts: The 2023 law excludes the Chief Justice of India from the selection process of the CEC and ECs. The Supreme Court split opinion involved Justice Dipankar Datta and Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, with the matter referred to Chief Justice Surya Kant.

Prelims pointers

- **Constitution:** The Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners are appointed by the President of India.
- **Body:** The Supreme Court of India is the highest judicial body in the country.
- **Fact:** The 2023 law specifically addresses the exclusion of the Chief Justice of India from the selection committee.

Mains question: *Examine the significance of judicial independence and the role of the judiciary in ensuring a transparent appointment process for the Election Commission of India.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/125227

Top Court Clamps Down On Misuse Of Child Abuse Law In Matrimonial Disputes

Why in news: The Supreme Court issued guidelines to prevent the misuse of the POCSO Act in matrimonial disputes by mandating expert evaluations before making arrests.

Key facts: The Supreme Court ruled that immediate arrests should be avoided in cases of alleged child sexual assault within matrimonial disputes. The court mandated psychological or psychiatric evaluations of children by experts to prevent trauma and public stigma.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** POCSO Act: Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012
- **Body:** Supreme Court: Highest judicial body in India, headed by the Chief Justice of India
- **Fact:** The ruling emphasizes the need for expert psychological/psychiatric evaluations before arrest

Mains question: *Discuss the challenges in balancing the protection of children under the POCSO Act with the prevention of its misuse in matrimonial disputes.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/125715

Supreme Court Questions How Minors Can Have Social Media Accounts

Why in news: The Supreme Court questioned the legality of minors holding social media accounts, noting that contracts entered by minors are void ab initio.

Key facts: The Supreme Court heard a plea from the NGO 'Just Rights for Children Alliance' regarding digital safeguards for children. The court directed social media platforms to adopt an 18-year age threshold for memberships.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** Supreme Court of India: The highest judicial body in India.
- **Fact:** Minors are legally incompetent to enter into binding contracts in India.
- **Fact:** The court directed an 18-year age threshold for social media memberships.

Mains question: *Discuss the legal and ethical challenges posed by the digital presence of minors and the necessity of robust regulatory frameworks to ensure child safety online.*

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127323](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127323)

Supreme Court Collegium recommends three High Court Chiefs for top judge roles

Why in news: The Supreme Court Collegium recommended three High Court Chief Justices for elevation to the Supreme Court, highlighting the judicial appointment process.

Key facts: The Collegium, consisting of the Chief Justice of India and four other judges, recommended Justice Sunita Agarwal (Gujarat), Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya (Delhi), and Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh (Telangana) for elevation. The recommendation follows the established procedure for judicial appointments in India.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** The Collegium system is the mechanism used by the Supreme Court of India to recommend names for judgeships.
- **Post:** The Collegium currently comprises the Chief Justice of India and four other senior-most judges.
- **Fact:** The three recommended judges represent the Gujarat, Delhi, and Telangana High Courts.

Mains question: *Critically examine the Collegium system of judicial appointments in India. Does it ensure transparency and accountability in the higher judiciary?*

Source: NDTV · [satyadheesh.in/news/127339](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127339)

HLCDC Seeks 15-Year Religion-Wise Data, Struggling States Face Constitutional Hurdles

Why in news: The High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes (HLCDC) requested religion-wise data from states, sparking a debate on the constitutionality of such data collection.

Key facts: The HLCDC was formed by the Ministry of Home Affairs to study demographic changes over a 15-year period. It requested data on birth/vehicle registrations, school enrolments, property transactions, and religious conversions among Scheduled Tribes.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** HLCDC: High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes formed by the Ministry of Home Affairs
- **Fact:** The committee seeks data spanning a 15-year period to analyze demographic trends
- **Place:** The committee visited Jammu and is scheduled to visit Maharashtra

Mains question: Discuss the constitutional and ethical implications of collecting religion-based demographic data by the state. Does such data collection compromise the principle of secularism?

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127345

Supreme Court Orders Delhi Police to Audit Lighting, CCTV After Recent Rapes

Why in news: The Supreme Court took suo motu cognizance of sexual assault incidents in Delhi-NCR, directing the Delhi Police to audit infrastructure and enhance patrolling to ensure the right to life and dignity.

Key facts: On September 28, 2026, the Supreme Court ordered the Delhi Police to audit lighting and CCTV coverage within four weeks. The court specifically cited incidents at Astha Kunj park and Swaroop Nagar as reasons for the intervention.

Prelims pointers

- **Constitution:** Article 21: Guarantees the right to life and personal liberty, which includes the right to live with dignity.
- **Body:** Delhi Police: The primary law enforcement agency for the National Capital Territory of Delhi.
- **Fact:** The court mandated a four-week timeline for the audit of lighting and CCTV coverage.

Mains question: Discuss the role of the judiciary in ensuring the right to safety and dignity for women in urban spaces. How can proactive policing mitigate crimes against women?

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127393

Ladakh Demands Sixth Schedule Status, MHA Proposes Directly Elected Body

Why in news: The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) proposed a directly elected legislative body for Ladakh as an alternative to the Sixth Schedule status demanded by locals.

Key facts: The Union Territory of Ladakh is seeking Sixth Schedule status for greater autonomy. The MHA has proposed a directly elected legislative body and the introduction of Article 371-K to balance local representation with national security concerns near the China border.

Prelims pointers

- **Constitution:** Sixth Schedule: Provides autonomy to tribal areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram.
- **Body:** Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA): Responsible for internal security and border management.
- **Fact:** Article 371-K: Proposed provision to provide special provisions for Ladakh.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges of balancing regional autonomy with national security concerns in strategically sensitive border regions like Ladakh.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127471](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127471)

Supreme Court Quashes Mulla Afroz's Detention, Imposes ₹10 Lakh Costs on UP Government

Why in news: The Supreme Court quashed a preventive detention order under the National Security Act (NSA) against Mulla Afroz, ruling that the detention was illegally exercised by the Uttar Pradesh government.

Key facts: The Supreme Court quashed an October 2025 detention order issued by the Sambhal District Magistrate. The court imposed a ₹10 lakh cost on the UP government for failing to consider relevant material and relying solely on a confessional statement.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** National Security Act (NSA) provides for preventive detention of individuals to prevent them from acting against state security.
- **Body:** Supreme Court of India: The highest judicial body in India, which has the power of judicial review over executive actions.
- **Fact:** The court imposed a cost of ₹10 lakh on the Uttar Pradesh government for the illegal exercise of detention powers.
- **Place:** Sambhal, Uttar Pradesh: Location of the 2024 violence and the subsequent legal proceedings.

Mains question: Critically examine the safeguards required to prevent the arbitrary exercise of preventive detention powers under the National Security Act to protect individual liberties.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127546](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127546)

Kunal Kamra Moves Supreme Court Over Freedom of Speech Threats

Why in news: Stand-up comedian Kunal Kamra moved the Supreme Court to seek clarity on whether legislative privileges override the fundamental right to freedom of speech.

Key facts: The Supreme Court is set to hear the case on October 6 regarding breach of privilege notices filed against Kamra. The issue involves a conflict between the privileges of MLAs and the constitutional right to free speech, with the court previously referring the matter to a seven-judge bench in 2003 and 2004.

Prelims pointers

- **Constitution:** Freedom of speech and expression is a Fundamental Right under Article 19(1)(a).
- **Body:** Legislative privileges are special rights and immunities enjoyed by members of the House (Lok Sabha/State Assemblies).
- **Fact:** The Supreme Court referred the matter to a seven-judge bench in 2003 and 2004 to resolve inconsistencies in previous rulings.

Mains question: *Examine the conflict between legislative privileges and the fundamental right to freedom of speech. Can legislative privileges be used to curtail democratic dissent?*

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127674](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127674)

In August 2026, the Supreme Court asked Union Ministries to address doxxing and deepfakes

Why in news: The Supreme Court directed Union Ministries to address doxxing and deepfakes following a PIL regarding surveillance and privacy rights.

Key facts: The Supreme Court heard a PIL filed by Rajya Sabha member A.A. Rahim against the Delhi Police's use of facial recognition technology. The court also upheld the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) conducted in May 2026.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** Supreme Court of India: The highest judicial body in India.
- **S&T:** Deepfakes: Synthetic media in which a person in an existing image or video is replaced by someone else's likeness.
- **S&T:** Doxxing: The act of publicly revealing private personal information about an individual without consent.
- **Fact:** Special Intensive Revision (SIR): A process used by the Election Commission for voter list updates.

Mains question: *Discuss the challenges posed by deepfakes and doxxing to the right to privacy and the necessity of a robust legal framework to regulate AI-driven surveillance.*

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/128025](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128025)

Election Chief Faces Petition for Database Tampering, Voter Disenfranchisement

Why in news: A petition was filed in the Supreme Court seeking an independent audit of Election Commission databases and the removal of statutory immunity for the CEC over alleged electoral roll tampering.

Key facts: The petition alleges unilateral alterations in voter registration and software failures leading to disenfranchisement. It cites Section 32 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) regarding cognisable offences.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Representation of the People Act, 1950: Governs the preparation and maintenance of electoral rolls.
- **Constitution:** Article 361: Provides immunity to the President and Governors; the petition argues CEC should not have similar immunity.
- **Body:** Election Commission of India (ECI): Constitutional body responsible for administering elections.
- **Fact:** Section 32 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950: Deals with offences related to electoral rolls.

Mains question: Discuss the importance of electoral integrity and the role of independent audits in ensuring the sanctity of the democratic process in India.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128140

Supreme Court to Examine Threat to Press Freedom in The Hindu Case

Why in news: The Supreme Court will examine the conflict between legislative privileges and freedom of the press in a 2003 case involving *The Hindu* and the Tamil Nadu Assembly.

Key facts: The case involves a 2003 resolution by the Tamil Nadu Assembly to arrest editorial staff of *The Hindu* for breaching legislative privileges. The Supreme Court has scheduled a seven-judge Bench to hear the matter on October 6, 2026, to determine the harmonious reading of Article 19(1) (a) and Article 194(3).

Prelims pointers

- **Constitution:** Article 19(1)(a): Guarantees freedom of speech and expression, including freedom of the press.
- **Constitution:** Article 194(3): Relates to the privileges of the House of the Legislature of a State.
- **Body:** Supreme Court: The highest judicial body in India, empowered to adjudicate on the constitutionality of legislative actions.

Mains question: Examine the constitutional conflict between the privileges of the legislature and the fundamental right to freedom of the press in India.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128174

Governance

Bills, Acts & ordinances · Prelims + Mains · 29 Sept

Union Government Seeks Supreme Court Stay on Great Nicobar Island Project Petitions

Why in news: The Union government moved the Supreme Court to stay hearings on the ₹92,000-crore Great Nicobar project due to allegations of violating the Forest Rights Act (FRA).

Key facts: The project is valued at ₹92,000 crore. The petitioner, Meena Gupta (retired IAS), alleges violations of the Forest Rights Act (FRA) regarding consent for the project. The Supreme Court is set to hear the Special Leave Petition (SLP) on October 5.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Forest Rights Act (FRA): Legislation providing forest-dwelling communities with legal rights over forest land.
- **Fact:** Great Nicobar Project: A mega-infrastructure project estimated at ₹92,000 crore.
- **Place:** Great Nicobar Island: An island in the Andaman and Nicobar archipelago.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges in balancing large-scale infrastructure development with the protection of tribal rights and forest conservation under the Forest Rights Act.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127949](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127949)

Social Justice

Health policy & public health · Prelims + Mains · 28 Sept

A retired bank employee suffering from breast cancer approached the Kerala High Court

Why in news: The Kerala High Court ruled that the central government can manufacture or authorize production of patented life-saving medicines at non-commercial rates for needy patients.

Key facts: The ruling was delivered by Justice Harisankar V Menon on September 16, 2022, regarding the drug Ribociclib. It invoked Section 100 of the Patents Act, 1970, to allow production of patented medicines for affordable access.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Patents Act, 1970: Governs the granting of patents and the rights of patent holders in India.
- **Fact:** Section 100 of the Patents Act: Provides for the compulsory licensing of patented inventions for the purpose of public health or national security.
- **Body:** Kerala High Court: The judicial body that issued the ruling regarding affordable access to life-saving drugs.

Mains question: Discuss the balance between protecting intellectual property rights and ensuring the right to health for marginalized sections in India.

Source: NDTV · [satyadheesh.in/news/127059](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127059)

India Had 50 Million Schoolchildren Without Sanitation in 2025: WHO/UNICEF Report

Why in news: A WHO/UNICEF report highlights that 50 million Indian schoolchildren still lack sanitation services despite progress under the Swachh Bharat Mission.

Key facts: The WHO/UNICEF report (Sept 2026) states India has the highest number of schoolchildren without sanitation services globally (50 million out of 244 million). While drinking water access improved, significant rural-urban gaps persist in hygiene services.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** WHO and UNICEF are the primary bodies responsible for the report on global school sanitation.
- **Scheme:** Swachh Bharat Mission was launched in 2014 to improve sanitation and hygiene.
- **Fact:** India has 50 million schoolchildren without sanitation services as of 2025.
- **Fact:** Only 12 million Indian children lack access to basic drinking water in schools.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges in achieving universal sanitation in rural schools and suggest measures to bridge the rural-urban hygiene gap in India.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127213](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127213)

India's Orphan Drug Potential: 1,004 Rare Disorders, \$100,000+ Treatments Await Solutions

Why in news: The article highlights India's potential to become a global hub for orphan drug manufacturing to address 1,004 rare genetic disorders.

Key facts: India reports 1,004 rare genetic disorders where treatments can cost over \$100,000 annually. The Orphan Drug Act of 1983 provides tax breaks and market exclusivity to incentivize development.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Orphan Drug Act (1983) provides tax breaks and market exclusivity for rare disease drugs
- **Fact:** India supports rare disease patients with subsidies up to Rs 50 lakh
- **Fact:** U.S. approved 1,122 orphan drugs post-Act implementation by 2022

Mains question: Discuss the challenges and opportunities for India in developing a robust ecosystem for orphan drugs to address the healthcare needs of patients with rare diseases.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127540](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127540)

International Relations

Regional & global groupings (QUAD, BRICS, SCO, G20...) · Prelims + Mains · 2 Sept

Modi meets Xi, Putin; tackles terrorism with Pakistan at SCO summit

Why in news: PM Modi engaged with leaders of China and Russia at the SCO summit in Bishkek to address regional terrorism and strengthen India's footprint in Central Asia.

Key facts: The summit took place in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan. India participated in the SCO Civilisational Dialogue Forum to balance relations with Russia and China while pursuing interests in Central Asia.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** SCO: Shanghai Cooperation Organisation is a Eurasian political, economic, and security alliance.
- **Place:** Bishkek is the capital of Kyrgyzstan.
- **Fact:** SCO members include China, Russia, India, Pakistan, and Central Asian nations.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) in shaping India's strategic autonomy and security cooperation in Central Asia.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/116387

Regional & global groupings (QUAD, BRICS, SCO, G20...) · Prelims + Mains · 2 Sept

Putin Proposes SCO Development Bank to Counter Western Sanctions

Why in news: President Putin proposed an SCO Development Bank at the 26th SCO Summit to create an independent financial framework and counter Western sanctions.

Key facts: The SCO now comprises 10 countries including China, India, Russia, Iran, and Central Asian states. It is projected to hold an estimated 34.3% of global GDP in PPP terms by 2026, potentially surpassing the G7.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** SCO: Shanghai Cooperation Organisation includes China, India, Russia, Iran, and Central Asian states.
- **Fact:** SCO projected to hold 34.3% of global GDP in PPP terms by 2026.
- **Post:** Vladimir Putin: President of Russia; Narendra Modi: Prime Minister of India.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) in creating an alternative economic and security architecture for the Global South.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/116453

After American forces resumed strikes against Iran, Iran launched missile and drone

Why in news: Escalation of military strikes between the US and Iran in the Middle East, specifically impacting the Strait of Hormuz.

Key facts: The US military claims strikes were a response to threats against American forces and shipping in the Strait of Hormuz. The Iranian Red Crescent reported a US missile hit a wedding in southern Iran, resulting in four fatalities.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Strait of Hormuz: A strategic chokepoint in the Middle East connecting the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman.
- **Fact:** The Iranian Red Crescent reported 4 fatalities in a southern Iran missile strike.
- **S&T:** The conflict involves the deployment of both missiles and drones as primary offensive weapons.

Mains question: *Analyze the impact of the escalating US-Iran tensions on global energy security and maritime trade routes in the Middle East.*

Source: BBC · satyadheesh.in/news/116684

Putin Orders Three-Day Halt to Strikes as US Envoys Propose Peace Talks

Why in news: President Putin ordered a three-day halt to strikes on Kyiv to facilitate peace talks proposed by US envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner.

Key facts: Russian President Vladimir Putin announced a temporary ceasefire via Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov. The halt coincides with the visit of US envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner to Ukraine to discuss ending the four-and-a-half-year conflict.

Prelims pointers

- **Post:** Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner: US envoys sent to negotiate peace in Ukraine.
- **Fact:** The Russia-Ukraine conflict has been ongoing for approximately four and a half years.
- **Place:** Kyiv: Capital of Ukraine, currently the site of the proposed peace talks.

Mains question: *Discuss the role of third-party mediation and diplomatic envoys in resolving protracted geopolitical conflicts like the Russia-Ukraine war.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/118009

US military strikes three Iranian oil tankers after IRGC missile attack on US warships

Why in news: The US military struck three Iranian oil tankers in the Gulf of Oman following a ballistic missile attack by the IRGC on US warships, escalating tensions in the Middle East.

Key facts: The US Central Command (CENTCOM) reported the destruction of two crude oil carriers and one additional tanker near Kharg Island. The IRGC's missile attack on US warships resulted in 18 US casualties and contributed to a spike in global energy prices.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Gulf of Oman: A strategic maritime waterway and key transit point for oil shipments.
- **Body:** IRGC: Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, an elite branch of the Iranian Armed Forces.
- **Body:** CENTCOM: United States Central Command, responsible for US military operations in the Middle East.
- **Fact:** The strikes targeted a multibillion-dollar financing network for IRGC proxies.

Mains question: *Analyze the impact of escalating maritime tensions in the Gulf of Oman on global energy security and India's strategic interests.*

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/118035

US Envoys Jared Kushner and Steve Witkoff Visit Kyiv for Ukraine War Talks

Why in news: US envoys Jared Kushner and Steve Witkoff visited Kyiv to engage in peace negotiations with Ukraine following talks with Russian President Vladimir Putin.

Key facts: The envoys visited Moscow before traveling to Kyiv to discuss ending the Russia-Ukraine war. A three-day truce was agreed upon by both sides to facilitate these negotiations. The mission aims to advance the US agenda of peace in Europe's most significant conflict since WWII.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Kyiv: Capital of Ukraine
- **Fact:** Russia-Ukraine war has lasted for over four years
- **Place:** Rzeszow: Polish city used as a transit point for the envoys

Mains question: *Discuss the role of third-party mediation in resolving protracted geopolitical conflicts and its impact on global security architecture.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/118300

Iran Claims Strike on US Vessel as Fighting Resumes in Strait of Hormuz

Why in news: Iran and the US engaged in direct maritime strikes in the Strait of Hormuz, threatening global oil supply chains and maritime security.

Key facts: Iran claimed to strike an unmanned US vessel in the Strait of Hormuz, while the US hit three Iranian oil tankers. The conflict involves the use of a 'shadow fleet' by Iran to bypass sanctions and the potential referral of Iran to the UN Security Council over nuclear issues.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Strait of Hormuz: A strategic chokepoint connecting the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea.
- **Fact:** The Strait of Hormuz is a primary transit point for a significant portion of the world's oil and liquefied natural gas (LNG).
- **Intl. org:** UN Security Council: The body responsible for maintaining international peace and security, where Iran may be referred regarding nuclear issues.

Mains question: *Analyze the geopolitical and economic implications of maritime instability in the Strait of Hormuz on global energy security and international trade routes.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/118369

Iran hails India as key diplomatic link before BRICS, eyes deep trade ties

Why in news: Iran highlighted India as a vital diplomatic hub and expressed interest in deepening trade ties ahead of the BRICS summit in New Delhi.

Key facts: Iranian Foreign Ministry Spokesperson Esmail Baghaei emphasized deepening bilateral trade and strategic cooperation. PM Modi and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian met in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, to discuss economic collaboration and the Chabahar Port.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Bishkek is the capital of Kyrgyzstan
- **Place:** Chabahar Port is a strategic maritime port in Iran
- **Body:** BRICS is a multilateral grouping including Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa
- **Fact:** PM Modi and President Pezeshkian's meeting in Bishkek was their first in two years

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of the Chabahar Port in strengthening India's connectivity with Central Asia and the importance of India-Iran bilateral ties in the context of regional stability.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/118885

The United Nations published a new map on July 1 depicting Arunachal

Why in news: The UN published a new map depicting Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin as contested regions following an African Union-backed resolution.

Key facts: The UN map, published on July 1, shows Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin as separate regions between Indian and Chinese border claims. It also includes a dotted line for the Line of Control (LoC) in Jammu and Kashmir.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin are territories currently under dispute between India and China.
- **Place:** The Line of Control (LoC) is the de facto border between India and Pakistan in Jammu and Kashmir.
- **Fact:** The UN map was released on July 1 following an African Union-backed resolution.

Mains question: Discuss the implications of international mapping and cartographic representations on India's territorial integrity and border management strategies.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/119076

Indian High Commissioner meets Bangladesh Minister to restart cross-border trains

Why in news: The Indian High Commissioner met the Bangladesh Transport Minister to discuss restarting cross-border passenger train services to boost regional connectivity.

Key facts: The meeting took place on September 8, 2026, in Dhaka. The Inter-Governmental Railway Meeting aims to resume three cross-border trains from Kolkata and New Jalpaiguri to Dhaka and Khulna by October 2026.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Kolkata and New Jalpaiguri are major railway hubs in West Bengal, India.
- **Fact:** Three cross-border trains are slated for resumption between India and Bangladesh.
- **Body:** The Inter-Governmental Railway Meeting is the annual bilateral forum for rail connectivity.

Mains question: Discuss how enhancing cross-border rail connectivity between India and Bangladesh can serve as a catalyst for regional economic integration and trade.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/119166

On Tuesday, US forces struck five Iranian tankers—sinking one—in response to Tehran

Why in news: US forces struck and sank Iranian oil tankers in the Gulf of Oman and near Kharg Island in retaliation for Iranian attacks on American warships and a base in Jordan.

Key facts: US Central Command (Centcom) reported striking five Iranian tankers, including the M/T Riesco, which sank in the Gulf of Oman. Iran launched 20 missiles at a US base in Jordan, 18 of which were intercepted. Kharg Island handles approximately 90% of Iran's crude oil exports.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Gulf of Oman: Region where the M/T Riesco was sunk.
- **Place:** Kharg Island: Major Iranian oil terminal and export hub.
- **Fact:** Brent crude rose by 1.5% to \$99.35 following the escalation.
- **Body:** US Central Command (Centcom): Command responsible for US military operations in the Middle East.

Mains question: *Analyze the impact of escalating maritime tensions in the Strait of Hormuz and Gulf of Oman on global energy security and international trade routes.*

Source: BBC · satyadheesh.in/news/119346

The IAEA accused Iran of noncompliance with nuclear commitments, passing a resolution

Why in news: The IAEA Board of Governors passed a resolution accusing Iran of noncompliance with nuclear non-proliferation commitments and referred the matter to the UN Security Council.

Key facts: The IAEA has been unable to inspect key Iranian nuclear sites (Fordow, Natanz, Isfahan) since June 2025 due to ongoing conflict. Iran is a signatory to the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT), which forbids nuclear weapons and requires IAEA safeguards.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** IAEA: International Atomic Energy Agency, responsible for nuclear safeguards and monitoring.
- **Intl. org:** UNSC: United Nations Security Council, the body to which the IAEA referred the Iran noncompliance matter.
- **Fact:** NPT: Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty, a multilateral treaty aimed at preventing the spread of nuclear weapons.
- **Place:** Strait of Hormuz: A strategic maritime chokepoint where US and Iran have traded vessel attacks.

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of the IAEA's role in ensuring global nuclear non-proliferation and the implications of non-compliance on regional and global security.*

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/119910

BRICS Surpasses G7: 41% Global GDP, Eyes Resilience in New Delhi Summit

Why in news: India is set to host the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi, highlighting the bloc's growing economic dominance over the G7.

Key facts: BRICS now accounts for 41% of global GDP, surpassing the G7's 28%. By 2026, BRICS nations are projected to account for 22% of India's exports and 41% of its imports.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** BRICS global GDP share: 41% (surpassing G7's 28%)
- **Fact:** India's trade dynamics: BRICS countries to account for 22% of exports and 41% of imports by 2026
- **Place:** 18th BRICS Summit: To be hosted in New Delhi, India (September 12-13)
- **Fact:** China and India together account for nearly 70% of the BRICS economy

Mains question: Discuss the growing economic significance of the BRICS bloc in the contemporary global order and its implications for India's trade dynamics.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/119988

BRICS leaders gather as Delhi braces for train cancellations and Metro changes

Why in news: The 18th BRICS Summit is scheduled to be held in New Delhi in September 2026, highlighting India's role in multilateral diplomacy.

Key facts: The summit will take place on September 12-13, 2026, in New Delhi. Key attendees include the leaders of Russia and China. Significant security measures and logistical adjustments for Delhi's transport infrastructure have been initiated.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (expanded in 2024).
- **Place:** New Delhi: Host city for the 18th BRICS Summit in 2026.
- **Fact:** The summit is scheduled for September 12-13, 2026.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of BRICS in shaping the global multi-polar order and India's strategic role within the bloc.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/120243

Putin says BRICS contributes more than 40% of global GDP at forum

Why in news: Vladimir Putin and Narendra Modi highlighted BRICS' growing economic dominance over the G7 at the BRICS Business Forum in New Delhi.

Key facts: BRICS currently contributes over 40% of global GDP, while the G7 contributes 29%. The BRICS grouping has expanded to include 21 members as of the forum.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** BRICS contribution to global GDP: >40%
- **Fact:** G7 contribution to global GDP: 29%
- **Fact:** Current BRICS membership: 21 members
- **Body:** BRICS: An association of emerging economies including India, Russia, Brazil, China, and South Africa.

Mains question: Discuss the shifting dynamics of global economic governance as BRICS emerges as a significant counterweight to the G7's traditional economic leadership.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/120424

At the Brics summit in Delhi, leaders from 11 nations including India

Why in news: BRICS leaders convened in Delhi to discuss financial cooperation and global trade dynamics amidst shifting US trade policies.

Key facts: The summit includes leaders from 11 nations, including the core members: India, China, Russia, Brazil, and South Africa. Key bilateral meetings involve Xi Jinping, Vladimir Putin, and Narendra Modi.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Fact:** The summit in Delhi involves 11 participating nations.
- **Post:** Narendra Modi: Prime Minister of India; Xi Jinping: President of China; Vladimir Putin: President of Russia.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of BRICS in shaping a multipolar world order and its role in fostering South-South cooperation in global trade.

Source: BBC · satyadheesh.in/news/120436

Houthis Seize Perim Island, Mokha, Tightening Red Sea Control

Why in news: Houthi rebels seized Perim Island and Mokha port, threatening the security of the Red Sea shipping lanes and global oil supply chains.

Key facts: The Houthis launched an offensive on September 3, seizing Perim Island and the port city of Mokha. The escalation has resulted in the displacement of at least 46,000 people and contributed to a rise in global oil prices.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Perim Island: A strategic island in the Red Sea, critical for maritime navigation.
- **Fact:** Displacement: At least 46,000 people displaced due to the recent Houthi offensive.
- **Fact:** Mokha: A strategic port city in Yemen currently under Houthi control.

Mains question: Analyze the impact of maritime insecurity in the Red Sea on global trade and India's energy security.

Source: BBC · satyadheesh.in/news/120509

EU Commission Proposes Free Trade Agreement with India, Aiming to Save €4 Billion Annually

Why in news: The European Commission proposed a Free Trade Agreement (FTA) with India to the European Council to enhance market access and reduce tariffs.

Key facts: The proposed FTA aims to reduce tariffs on 96% of EU goods exports to India. It is projected to save approximately €4 billion annually in duties and support over 800,000 EU jobs.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** European Commission: The executive branch of the European Union responsible for proposing legislation.
- **Fact:** The proposed FTA aims to reduce tariffs on 96% of EU goods exports to India.
- **Fact:** The agreement is estimated to save €4 billion annually in duties.

Mains question: Discuss how a Free Trade Agreement with the European Union can bolster India's position in the Indo-Pacific region and impact its manufacturing sector.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/120527

Houthis Capture 130km Yemen Coast, Threaten Red Sea Trade Backed by Iran

Why in news: Houthi rebels captured 130km of Yemen's coastline, threatening Red Sea shipping lanes and international trade routes with Iranian backing.

Key facts: The Houthis have seized a 130km stretch of the Tihamah coastal plain. This move provides them control over strategic areas near the Bab al-Mandab Strait, a critical maritime chokepoint for global trade.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Bab al-Mandab Strait: A strategic maritime chokepoint connecting the Red Sea to the Gulf of Aden.
- **Fact:** Houthis captured 130km of the Yemen coastline in the Tihamah region.
- **Fact:** The Houthi movement is a non-state actor in Yemen backed by Iran.

Mains question: *Analyze the impact of maritime insecurity in the Red Sea on global trade and India's energy security. Suggest measures to ensure freedom of navigation.*

Source: BBC · satyadheesh.in/news/120573

Leaders of BRICS member states, including China and Russia along with Iran

Why in news: BRICS leaders are meeting in New Delhi to discuss strengthening emerging economies and the influence of the Global South amidst US-Iran tensions.

Key facts: The summit includes representatives from 11 nations, including China, Russia, Iran, UAE, and Saudi Arabia. The meeting focuses on reshaping global economic dynamics and addressing trade tensions involving the US-Israel alliance.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Fact:** The current summit includes representatives from 11 member nations.
- **Place:** New Delhi, India: Host city for the BRICS summit.

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of BRICS in elevating the influence of the Global South and its role in reshaping the current global economic order.*

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/120574

India aims to broker truce between Iran and UAE at BRICS summit

Why in news: India aims to leverage its BRICS chairmanship to mediate a truce between Iran and the UAE to stabilize regional energy supplies and mitigate economic inflation.

Key facts: India is hosting the expanded BRICS summit with 11 member states and 10 partner countries. The conflict between Iran and the UAE has directly impacted India's energy security, leading to surged oil prices and inflation.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Fact:** The expanded BRICS bloc includes 11 member states and 10 partner countries.
- **Post:** Masoud Pezeshkian: The current President of Iran.
- **Place:** Bishkek: The capital of Kyrgyzstan, where PM Modi met the Iranian President.

Mains question: Discuss India's growing role as a 'leading power' in the Global South through its mediation efforts in regional conflicts and multilateral forums like BRICS.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/120766

BRICS leaders condemn Pahalgam attack, vow action against terror financing

Why in news: BRICS leaders issued a 140-point declaration condemning the Pahalgam terror attack and pledging to combat cross-border terror financing.

Key facts: The BRICS summit was held in New Delhi. The declaration specifically addressed the April 22, 2025, attack in Pahalgam, J&K, which resulted in 26 fatalities.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Fact:** The Pahalgam attack on April 22, 2025, resulted in 26 deaths.
- **Fact:** The New Delhi summit produced a 140-point declaration on security and cooperation.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of multilateral cooperation in combating cross-border terrorism and terror financing in the contemporary global order.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/120852

BRICS Summit Begins with Modi's Call for Global South Leadership, Adoption of Delhi Declaration

Why in news: The BRICS summit in Delhi saw the adoption of the Delhi Declaration and PM Modi's push for Global South leadership, highlighting India's role in multilateral diplomacy.

Key facts: The summit included leaders from India, Russia, China, Iran, and Indonesia. The Delhi Declaration was adopted after negotiations, specifically condemning terrorism and unilateral acts of war.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Fact:** The Delhi Declaration was the primary outcome of the summit, focusing on global governance and security.
- **Place:** The summit took place in Delhi, India.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the 'Global South' concept in contemporary multilateralism and India's role in shaping the agenda of the BRICS bloc.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/120918

Xi Jinping urges BRICS to oppose sovereignty violations at New Delhi summit

Why in news: Chinese President Xi Jinping urged BRICS nations to oppose sovereignty violations and cooperate on AI during the New Delhi Summit.

Key facts: The BRICS Summit took place in New Delhi with key discussions on Middle East conflict, multilateral trade, and AI cooperation. Xi Jinping and PM Modi scheduled a bilateral meeting to address trade and border tensions.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (plus new members).
- **Fact:** The New Delhi Summit focused on multilateral trade and opposition to protectionism.
- **S&T:** AI cooperation was proposed as a key pillar for new industrialization within the BRICS framework.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of BRICS as a platform for the Global South to advocate for multilateralism and reform of the global economic order.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/120936

BRICS Strains as Iran-UAE Crisis Disrupts New Delhi Meetings

Why in news: The 2026 Iran-UAE confrontation and subsequent trade suspension by Abu Dhabi disrupted BRICS meetings in New Delhi, highlighting the challenges of consensus-building in an expanded bloc.

Key facts: The crisis involved a US-Israeli military campaign against Iran and a trade suspension by Abu Dhabi. It significantly impacted the Strait of Hormuz, a critical global maritime chokepoint, and tested the BRICS consensus-driven model.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa, recently expanded to include Iran and the UAE.
- **Place:** Strait of Hormuz: A strategic waterway connecting the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea.
- **Fact:** The 2026 Iran-UAE crisis disrupted diplomatic efforts during BRICS meetings held in New Delhi.

Mains question: *Analyze the challenges faced by BRICS in maintaining internal cohesion and consensus-driven diplomacy following its recent expansion.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/120938

UAE Leads with 3.2 Million: India's Overseas Population Hits 18.5 Million

Why in news: UN DESA released the International Migrant Stock 2024 report, highlighting that 18.5 million Indian-born people live abroad, with the UAE and US leading the host countries.

Key facts: The UN DESA report identifies 18.5 million Indian-born residents globally. The UAE and USA share the top spot with 3.2 million each, while Saudi Arabia follows with 2 million. Pakistan hosts 1.6 million residents, largely due to pre-Partition historical contexts.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Total Indian-born population living abroad as of 2024: 18.5 million
- **Fact:** UAE and USA are the top host countries for Indian migrants with 3.2 million each
- **Fact:** Saudi Arabia ranks third with approximately 2 million Indian-born residents
- **Fact:** Pakistan hosts 1.6 million Indian-born residents due to pre-1947 historical context
- **Body:** UN DESA (United Nations Department of Economic and Social Affairs) tracks international migrant stocks

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of the Indian diaspora in strengthening India's soft power and economic ties with the Middle East and Western nations.*

Source: Times of India · satyadheesh.in/news/120951

Modi pushes to reshape UN Security Council at BRICS Summit

Why in news: PM Modi advocated for UN Security Council reforms at the 18th BRICS Summit, seeking a shift from a 'pyramid' to a 'platform of partnership' model.

Key facts: The 18th BRICS Summit resulted in the 'New Delhi Declaration' which calls for equitable representation in international institutions. Stéphane Dujarric, spokesperson for UN Secretary-General António Guterres, supported the call for UN Security Council reform.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** UN Security Council: Currently consists of 15 members, with 5 permanent members (P5) holding veto power.
- **Fact:** BRICS: An acronym for Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Place:** New Delhi Declaration: Adopted during the 18th BRICS Summit.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges and necessity of reforming the UN Security Council to reflect the contemporary global order and the aspirations of the Global South.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/121112

Modi, Putin vow \$100 billion trade by 2030 amid global sanctions

Why in news: PM Modi and President Putin met in Delhi to discuss the Programme for Economic Cooperation 2030, aiming for \$100 billion in bilateral trade by 2030.

Key facts: The meeting took place on September 11 in Delhi. Key discussions included maritime trade security, seafarer safety, and the INNOPROM India exhibition. The leaders also discussed the role of BRICS in navigating global sanctions.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Target trade volume between India and Russia: \$100 billion by 2030.
- **Body:** BRICS: A grouping of five countries (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa) for economic cooperation.
- **Place:** INNOPROM India: An exhibition platform for industrial and technological cooperation.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of India-Russia economic cooperation in the context of global geopolitical shifts and the evolving dynamics of the BRICS framework.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/121175

Modi meets El-Sisi: Egypt's first BRICS summit as full member

Why in news: Egypt joined BRICS as a full member in January 2024, and PM Modi met President El-Sisi at the 18th BRICS Summit to discuss inclusive global growth.

Key facts: Egypt officially joined BRICS as a full member in January 2024. The 18th BRICS Summit took place in New Delhi, where PM Modi and President El-Sisi discussed the role of the Global South.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Fact:** Egypt joined BRICS as a full member in January 2024.
- **Place:** New Delhi: Venue of the 18th BRICS Summit.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of BRICS expansion and its role in promoting the interests of the Global South in the contemporary global economic order.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/121186

This weekend in Delhi, Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi hosted the Brics

Why in news: PM Modi hosted the BRICS summit in Delhi, where leaders issued a joint declaration on conflict restraint while navigating geopolitical tensions.

Key facts: The summit included leaders from India, China, Russia, Iran, UAE, and South Africa. The joint declaration emphasized 'maximum restraint' in conflicts but notably avoided naming specific conflicts like the Russia-Ukraine war.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (expanded to include new members).
- **Fact:** The summit featured leaders from Iran and the UAE, reflecting the bloc's expanding geopolitical reach.
- **Place:** Delhi, India: Host city for the recent BRICS summit.

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of BRICS as a platform for reshaping the global order and its role in promoting a multipolar world.*

Source: BBC · satyadheesh.in/news/121269

Israeli strike in Gaza dismembers two, wounds 13; over 1,300 killed since October

Why in news: Ongoing Israeli military strikes in Gaza and the resulting humanitarian crisis highlight the complexities of the US-brokered ceasefire and regional instability.

Key facts: Israeli air strikes in Gaza City's Tal al-Hawa neighborhood targeted a vehicle allegedly containing Hamas fighters. Since October, over 1,300 Palestinians have been killed, and fuel shortages are causing hospital generator failures.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Over 1,300 Palestinians killed in Gaza since the October ceasefire began.
- **Fact:** Hospitals in Gaza require approximately 2,500 litres of oil monthly, but current supplies are limited to emergency needs.
- **Place:** Tal al-Hawa is a neighborhood in Gaza City.

Mains question: *Discuss the impact of the Israel-Palestine conflict on regional stability and the role of international mediation in addressing humanitarian crises.*

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/121397

On 13 September 2026, Indian High Commissioner Dinesh Trivedi met with high-level

Why in news: Indian High Commissioner Dinesh Trivedi met Bangladeshi officials to discuss normalizing ties and the upcoming expiration of the Ganges Water Sharing Treaty in December 2026.

Key facts: The meeting involved Indian High Commissioner Dinesh Trivedi and Bangladeshi officials including Adviser Dr. Zahed Ur Rahman and Minister of Water Resources Mr. Md. Shahiduddin Chowdhury Anee. The primary focus was on the Ganges Water Sharing Treaty and enhancing people-to-people relations.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Ganges Water Sharing Treaty: A bilateral agreement between India and Bangladesh regarding the sharing of Ganges river water.
- **Fact:** The Ganges Water Sharing Treaty is set to expire in December 2026.
- **Post:** Dinesh Trivedi: Indian High Commissioner to Bangladesh.

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of transboundary water-sharing agreements in fostering regional stability and bilateral cooperation between India and Bangladesh.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/121426

UN Secretary General says UN has not published border-defining map for India

Why in news: UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres clarified that the UN does not publish border-defining maps following India's criticism of a map used during a resolution.

Key facts: The UN Geospatial map used in consultations depicted Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin without specified Indian and Chinese claim lines. The statement was made by UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres in response to India's concerns regarding the 'Correct the Map' resolution.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin are disputed territories between India and China.
- **Body:** The UN Geospatial is the body responsible for the map in question.
- **Fact:** The map was used during the 'Correct the Map' resolution at the UN.

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of cartographic accuracy and sovereign boundaries in maintaining international peace and India's strategic interests in the context of UN resolutions.*

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/121513

Modi meets African leaders, covers health crises and tech partnerships at BRICS Summit

Why in news: PM Modi engaged with African leaders at the 18th BRICS Summit to discuss bilateral cooperation in health, technology, and economic development.

Key facts: PM Modi met leaders from Ethiopia, South Africa, Burundi, Uganda, and Nigeria during the 18th BRICS Summit. Discussions focused on regional developments, health crises, and technology partnerships.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (recently expanded).
- **Place:** Ethiopia: Host country of the 18th BRICS Summit.
- **Fact:** The summit took place on September 12-13, 2026.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of India's 'South-South Cooperation' with African nations in the context of global health and technological equity.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/121535](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/121535)

India Shines as Diplomatic Bridge at 18th BRICS Summit, Pushing Global Governance Reforms

Why in news: India hosted the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi, positioning itself as a diplomatic bridge to advocate for global governance reforms.

Key facts: The 18th BRICS Summit took place in New Delhi on September 14, 2026. The summit resulted in the 'New Delhi Declaration,' focusing on trade cooperation and reforming global governance structures.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (plus new members).
- **Place:** New Delhi: Host city for the 18th BRICS Summit in September 2026.
- **Fact:** New Delhi Declaration: The primary outcome document of the 18th BRICS Summit.

Mains question: Discuss India's role as a 'diplomatic bridge' in the context of BRICS and its efforts toward reforming global governance structures.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/121595](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/121595)

China's Foreign Minister: India and China Reach "Important Consensus" at BRICS Summit

Why in news: China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi announced an 'important consensus' between India and China to act as partners during the BRICS Summit in New Delhi.

Key facts: The announcement was made on September 12, 2026, during the BRICS Summit in New Delhi. It follows a normalization of relations in October 2024 after a four-year freeze in bilateral ties.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (plus new members).
- **Place:** New Delhi: Host city for the September 2026 BRICS Summit.
- **Fact:** Relations normalized in October 2024 after a four-year freeze.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the 'important consensus' between India and China in the context of regional stability and the evolving dynamics of the BRICS framework.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/121854](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/121854)

Finland Joins France's Nuclear Deterrence, Amid Russian Threats

Why in news: Finland joined France's Forward Deterrence Initiative to bolster European security against Russian threats, marking a shift in regional nuclear cooperation.

Key facts: Finland is the 10th European state to join France's Forward Deterrence Initiative. The agreement includes the establishment of a nuclear steering group and clarifies that it does not replace the NATO nuclear umbrella.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Finland is the 10th European state to join France's Forward Deterrence Initiative.
- **Place:** The agreement was formalized in Helsinki, Finland.
- **Fact:** Finland does not plan to station nuclear weapons on its territory during peacetime.
- **Place:** The Gulf of Finland is the site where a vessel suspected of sabotaging undersea cables was seized.

Mains question: Discuss the implications of expanding European nuclear deterrence frameworks in the context of evolving security dynamics in the Baltic region.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/121876

India to Export Power to Nepal for 18 Hours Daily, Aiding Flood-Ravaged Recovery

Why in news: India's Ministry of Power approved exporting electricity to Nepal for 18 hours daily to assist in flood recovery and strengthen bilateral energy ties.

Key facts: The Ministry of Power approved power exports to Nepal from Sept 13, 2024, to Dec 31, 2026. In FY 2025-26, India imported 3,299 million units (MUs) from Nepal and exported 1,451 MUs.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India exported 1,451 MUs to Nepal in FY 2025-26.
- **Fact:** India imported 3,299 MUs from Nepal in FY 2025-26.
- **Place:** Nepal: Landlocked neighbor of India.
- **Post:** Ministry of Power: Central government body overseeing power sector.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of India-Nepal energy cooperation in the context of regional connectivity and disaster resilience.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/121886

Under a free trade agreement, India will export up to 1.64 million

Why in news: India and the EU reached a free trade agreement (FTA) allowing India to export significantly higher volumes of steel to the EU market.

Key facts: The agreement allows India to export up to 1.64 million metric tons of steel annually to the EU. It includes a preferential quota of 694,853 tons on top of the existing 946,616 ton WTO quota. The agreement was released on September 11, 2026.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India's new steel export capacity to the EU covers approximately 68.4% of its 2025 shipments.
- **S&T:** Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) is an EU policy that applies to Indian steel exports despite the FTA.
- **Fact:** The preferential quota for steel is 694,853 tons above the existing WTO quota.

Mains question: Discuss the implications of the EU's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) on India's export-oriented manufacturing sector and suggest measures to mitigate its impact.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/121935

US Deploys Space Weapon in Orbit for First Time

Why in news: The US deployed its first orbital space weapon to counter perceived threats from Russia and China, signaling a shift toward active space warfare.

Key facts: US Secretary of the Air Force Troy Meink confirmed the deployment of a space weapon in Earth's orbit. The move is linked to the 'Golden Dome' system and follows Russia's February 2024 launch of a satellite capable of attacking other satellites.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** Space weapon: A device designed to damage, disable, or destroy satellites or space stations.
- **Fact:** Russia launched a satellite in February 2024 with potential offensive capabilities.
- **Post:** Troy Meink: US Secretary of the Air Force.

Mains question: Discuss the implications of space weaponization on global security and the necessity of establishing international norms for peaceful space exploration.

Source: BBC · satyadheesh.in/news/121955

US Deploys Space Weapons, Sparking Fears of Arms Race with China and Russia

Why in news: The US Air Force Secretary confirmed the deployment of space weapons, escalating concerns regarding a space arms race with China and Russia.

Key facts: The US Air Force revealed the deployment of counterspace weapons including jammers and kinetic systems. China and Russia are identified as primary adversaries with substantial counterspace programs. India demonstrated ASAT capability in 2019 and currently focuses on space situational awareness.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** Kinetic systems and jammers are primary types of counterspace weapons.
- **Fact:** India successfully demonstrated ASAT (Anti-Satellite) capability in 2019.
- **S&T:** Space Situational Awareness (SSA) involves monitoring the positions and activities of objects in space.

Mains question: Discuss the implications of a space arms race on global security and the importance of international norms for the peaceful use of outer space.

Source: Times of India · satyadheesh.in/news/122240

Trump and Xi to Meet on AI Issues Next Week

Why in news: US President Donald Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping are scheduled to meet in Washington to discuss critical AI-related issues including chip exports and military risks.

Key facts: The meeting involves discussions on technology copying, chip export restrictions, and differing regulatory approaches. Key officials involved include US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and Chinese Vice Premier He Lifeng.

Prelims pointers

- **Post:** Scott Bessent: US Treasury Secretary
- **Post:** He Lifeng: Chinese Vice Premier
- **Fact:** Key issues include military AI risks and tech theft via distillation
- **S&T:** AI supremacy race involves chip export restrictions and regulatory divergence

Mains question: Discuss the implications of the US-China competition for AI supremacy on global technological governance and international security.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/122677

India warns that new US tariffs over Russian oil could strain bilateral

Why in news: India expressed concern over a US House bill allowing up to 100% tariffs on Russian oil imports, potentially impacting India-US trade relations and India's energy security.

Key facts: The US House of Representatives passed a bill authorizing President Donald Trump to impose tariffs of up to 100% on countries importing Russian oil. India is currently one of the largest buyers of Russian oil to maintain economic stability and energy security.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** The proposed US tariff on Russian oil imports can reach up to 100%.
- **Place:** India is identified as a major importer of Russian oil for domestic energy security.
- **Body:** The US House of Representatives is the legislative body that passed the bill.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges India faces in balancing its strategic partnership with the US while maintaining energy security through trade with Russia.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/122718

The US Congress passed a bill giving President Donald Trump sweeping powers

Why in news: The US Congress passed the 'Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia Act of 2026' to impose heavy tariffs and sanctions on major buyers of Russian crude oil, including India and China.

Key facts: The bill allows for tariffs up to 100% on the top five purchasers of Russian energy and up to 500% on Russian imports into the US. It targets officials, companies, and oil tankers to weaken Russian funding for the war in Ukraine.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** The Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia Act of 2026 proposes tariffs up to 100% on top Russian energy purchasers.
- **Fact:** The bill proposes up to 500% tariffs on Russian imports directly into the United States.
- **Place:** The act specifically targets major buyers of Russian crude, including China and India.

Mains question: Discuss the implications of unilateral US sanctions on global energy trade and the challenges it poses for the economic interests of emerging economies like India.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/122798

Russia and China Veto US-backed Iran Sanctions Resolution at UN

Why in news: Russia and China vetoed a US-backed UN Security Council resolution to extend the mandate for monitoring sanctions on Iran, highlighting geopolitical friction over the 2015 nuclear pact.

Key facts: The UN Security Council vote saw 11 members in favor, with Pakistan and Somalia abstaining. The veto ends the independent panel's role in monitoring sanctions reimposed against Iran in September 2025 via the 'snapback' mechanism.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** UN Security Council: The body responsible for maintaining international peace and security, where veto power is held by P5 members.
- **Fact:** Snapback Mechanism: A provision in the 2015 Iran Nuclear Deal (JCPOA) allowing the restoration of previous UN sanctions.
- **Intl. org:** P5 Members: China, France, Russia, UK, and USA hold permanent seats and veto power in the UNSC.

Mains question: Analyze how the use of the veto power by permanent members of the UN Security Council impacts the efficacy of international sanctions regimes.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/122970

Trump signs sweeping Russia sanctions over Ukraine war | Russia-Ukraine war News

Why in news: President Donald Trump signed the Lindsey O'Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, imposing sweeping sanctions on Russia's energy and defense sectors to curb war funding.

Key facts: The act targets Russian officials, oligarchs, banks, energy, and defense sectors. It grants authority to impose tariffs up to 100% on major Russian oil and gas importers, specifically mentioning China and India.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** The Lindsey O'Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 allows for tariffs up to 100% on Russian oil and gas importers.
- **Body:** The act targets Russian oligarchs and the energy/defense sectors to weaken war funding.
- **Place:** India and China are identified as major importers of Russian oil and gas under the potential tariff scope.

Mains question: Discuss how economic sanctions and trade barriers serve as instruments of geopolitical pressure in modern international conflicts.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/123420

The Nepal floods question: When the Himalayas collapse, who gets warned?

Why in news: A massive ice-rock avalanche in Nepal's Rasuwa district caused catastrophic floods in Nepal and Tibet, highlighting the urgent need for cross-border early warning systems in the Himalayas.

Key facts: On August 26, an ice-rock avalanche triggered floods in the Lhende Khola River, killing over 1,400 people and leaving 6,000 missing across Nepal and Tibet. The disaster destroyed 12 hydropower plants and highlighted the risks posed by climate-induced changes to high-altitude environments.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Rasuwa district: A district in Nepal where the ice-rock avalanche occurred.
- **Fact:** Lhende Khola River: The river through which the flood surge traveled towards the Nepal-China border.
- **Environment:** Climate change impacts: Warming is altering glaciers, snow cover, permafrost, and high-altitude lakes in the Himalayas.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges of establishing cross-border disaster management and early warning systems in the Himalayan region amidst escalating climate risks.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/123502

Iran war live: Tehran sets terms for peace; Saudi forces foil Riyadh attack | US-Israel war on Iran News

Why in news: Iran has communicated specific peace conditions to the US via Qatari mediators amidst ongoing conflict, highlighting the role of regional mediation in geopolitical tensions.

Key facts: Iran's top security official, Mohsen Rezaei, communicated demands to the US on September 20, 2026. The demands include a ceasefire on all fronts, release of frozen assets, and lifting of the US naval blockade on Iranian ports.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Iran's peace demands include the release of frozen assets and lifting of the US naval blockade.
- **Place:** Qatar is acting as a mediator in the peace negotiations between Iran and the US.
- **Post:** Mohsen Rezaei is identified as Iran's top security official.

Mains question: *Analyze the role of regional powers like Qatar in mediating Middle Eastern conflicts and the impact of economic sanctions on regional stability.*

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/123845

India's UN Security Council Seat Bid Gets Support From 4 European Countries

Why in news: India's Foreign Minister S. Jaishankar met with the Visegrad Group (V4) leaders at the 81st UN General Assembly, where they pledged support for India's permanent UNSC seat.

Key facts: The Visegrad Group (V4) consists of Poland, Hungary, Slovakia, and the Czech Republic. The meeting resulted in an agreement to establish an annual business forum and deepen cooperation in technology, space, and defence.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** Visegrad Group (V4): An intergovernmental organization consisting of Poland, Hungary, Slovakia, and the Czech Republic.
- **Body:** UNSC: The United Nations Security Council is the primary organ responsible for maintaining international peace and security.
- **Fact:** The meeting took place on the margins of the 81st session of the UN General Assembly.
- **Place:** V4 countries are located in Central Europe.

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of India's growing strategic partnerships with the Visegrad Group in the context of its bid for a permanent seat in the UN Security Council.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/124710

Xi-Trump summit: China puts Taiwan 'red line' at centre of US ties

Why in news: China issued a warning regarding Taiwan as a 'red line' ahead of a high-level summit between Xi Jinping and Donald Trump to discuss security and trade.

Key facts: The summit addresses tensions over Taiwan, trade, and a proposed USD 11 billion US arms package for Taiwan. China also requested tighter controls on chemicals used in fentanyl production.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Proposed US arms package for Taiwan: USD 11 billion
- **Place:** Taiwan: A territory claimed by China, currently a self-governing entity.
- **S&T:** Fentanyl: A potent synthetic opioid whose production chemicals are a point of bilateral negotiation.

Mains question: *Analyze the impact of the Taiwan issue on the evolving dynamics of India-China-US trilateral relations and global maritime security.*

Source: Times of India · satyadheesh.in/news/124887

Why is the Bab al-Mandab Strait so important?

Why in news: The strategic importance of the Bab al-Mandab Strait has led to UK military support for Saudi Arabia against Houthi rebels in Yemen.

Key facts: The Bab al-Mandab Strait is a key maritime chokepoint connecting the Red Sea to the Gulf of Aden. Iran-backed Houthi rebels seized territory near the strait, prompting a Saudi-led coalition intervention since 2015.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Bab al-Mandab Strait: Connects the Red Sea to the Gulf of Aden and the Arabian Sea.
- **Fact:** Houthi rebels: An Iran-backed militant group that seized Sanaa in 2014.
- **Fact:** Saudi-led coalition: Intervened in Yemen in 2015 to restore government rule.

Mains question: *Analyze the geopolitical significance of maritime chokepoints like the Bab al-Mandab Strait in global energy security and regional stability.*

Source: BBC · satyadheesh.in/news/124943

US signs 'tremendous' Arctic security deal with Denmark, Greenland

Why in news: The US, Denmark, and Greenland signed a security deal to expand the US military presence in Greenland to counter Arctic rivals like Russia and China.

Key facts: The agreement allows for expanded activities at the Pituffik Space Base and establishes new bases at Narsarsuaq and Mestersvig. It prohibits non-NATO countries from establishing military installations without unanimous approval and has no expiration date.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Pituffik Space Base: A key US military installation located in Greenland.
- **Body:** NATO: The agreement was welcomed by NATO as a measure to enhance Arctic security.
- **Fact:** The deal includes the establishment of new bases at Narsarsuaq and Mestersvig.

Mains question: *Discuss the growing significance of the Arctic region in global geopolitics and the implications of increased military presence for international security.*

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/124957

US, Iran hold mediated UNGA talks on ending war, opening Strait of Hormuz | US-Israel war on Iran News

Why in news: The US and Iran held mediated talks during the UN General Assembly to discuss de-escalating tensions and reopening the Strait of Hormuz.

Key facts: The talks took place on September 21 in New York during the UN General Assembly. Iran's primary demands include lifting naval blockades, unfreezing assets, and easing military pressure.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Strait of Hormuz: A strategic maritime chokepoint connecting the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman.
- **Fact:** The Strait of Hormuz is critical for the transit of global oil and liquefied natural gas (LNG) shipments.
- **Post:** Steve Witkoff: US Special Envoy involved in the mediation process.

Mains question: *Analyze the geopolitical significance of the Strait of Hormuz and the implications of US-Iran de-escalation on global energy security.*

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/125126

Trump-Xi summit: \$14 billion Taiwan arms deal hangs over Washington talks

Why in news: The upcoming Trump-Xi summit in Washington is expected to center on China's demand to halt a \$14 billion US arms deal to Taiwan, citing the 1982 US-China agreement.

Key facts: President Xi Jinping is seeking a halt to US arms sales to Taiwan, which Beijing views as provocative. The pending arms deal is valued at \$14 billion. The 1982 US-China agreement serves as the primary diplomatic framework for these negotiations.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** The pending US arms deal to Taiwan is valued at \$14 billion.
- **Intl. org:** The 1982 US-China agreement governs the framework for arms sales and regional stability.
- **Place:** Taiwan is the primary recipient of the contested arms sales.

Mains question: *Discuss how the issue of arms sales to Taiwan impacts the strategic balance in the Indo-Pacific and the efficacy of bilateral agreements between the US and China.*

Source: Times of India · satyadheesh.in/news/125273

Vladimir Putin: Another Donald Trump-Putin meeting soon? US invites Russian President to G20 summit in December

Why in news: US Secretary of State Marco Rubio announced an invitation to Russian President Vladimir Putin for the December G20 summit to facilitate direct engagement with Donald Trump regarding the Russia-Ukraine war.

Key facts: The US has invited Vladimir Putin to the G20 summit in December to discuss the Russia-Ukraine conflict. Discussions between Marco Rubio and Sergei Lavrov at the UN General Assembly highlighted interests in a limited ceasefire for grain and energy.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** G20: An intergovernmental forum comprising 19 sovereign countries and the European Union.
- **Post:** Marco Rubio: Serving as the US Secretary of State.
- **Fact:** The meeting aims to address the Russia-Ukraine war and bilateral relations.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of multilateral forums like the G20 in mediating geopolitical conflicts and fostering bilateral cooperation between major powers.

Source: Times of India · satyadheesh.in/news/125351

Trump administration invites Putin to attend G20 summit in Miami

Why in news: The Trump administration invited Russian President Vladimir Putin to the G20 summit in Miami to facilitate global engagement despite ongoing tensions over the Ukraine conflict.

Key facts: US Secretary of State Marco Rubio met with Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov at the UN General Assembly. The invitation comes despite an ICC arrest warrant for Putin and Ukraine's call for increased financial pressure on Russia.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** G20: An intergovernmental forum of 19 countries and the European Union.
- **Post:** Marco Rubio: Serving as the US Secretary of State.
- **Body:** ICC: International Criminal Court, an intergovernmental organization and founding treaty organization.
- **Place:** Miami, Florida: Proposed venue for the G20 summit.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges of maintaining multilateral cooperation in the G20 amidst escalating geopolitical tensions and international legal sanctions.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/125369

Donald Trump Xi Jinping LIVE Updates: US-China Summit White House State Visit Key Announcements Trade AI Live News

Why in news: President Xi Jinping's state visit to the US and meeting with Donald Trump highlights the shift towards cooperation in trade and AI between the world's two largest economies.

Key facts: Chinese President Xi Jinping arrived in Maryland for a three-day state visit to the US on September 23. This visit marks the first such personal welcome by a US President since 1962, focusing on trade tariffs, technology, and AI cooperation.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Joint Base Andrews: A major US military installation in Maryland used for receiving heads of state.
- **Fact:** The visit marks the first such welcome since 1962.
- **S&T:** AI (Artificial Intelligence) and trade tariffs are primary pillars of the US-China bilateral agenda.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the US-China relationship in shaping global trade and technological standards, particularly in the realm of Artificial Intelligence.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/125641

At the 81st UN General Assembly, India and Liberia established a "group

Why in news: India and Liberia established a 'Group of Friends' at the 81st UN General Assembly to address maritime security and seafarer safety amid rising attacks in global shipping lanes.

Key facts: India is a major source of seafarers, while Liberia is the world's largest shipping registry. The initiative targets security risks in regions like the Red Sea, Gulf of Oman, and the Strait of Hormuz.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** The initiative was launched during the 81st UN General Assembly (UNGA).
- **Fact:** Liberia is recognized as the largest shipping registry globally.
- **Fact:** Key maritime chokepoints mentioned include the Strait of Hormuz, Bab-el-Mandeb, and the Gulf of Aden.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of maritime security in ensuring global trade stability and India's role in safeguarding international shipping lanes.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/126138

Trump confirms Ukraine will get Patriot missile licences, but production takes over a year

Why in news: President Donald Trump confirmed that Ukraine will receive licenses to produce Patriot missiles to counter Russian drone and missile attacks.

Key facts: The US confirmed licenses for Ukraine to produce Patriot missiles. While the license is granted, establishing the actual production capacity is estimated to take over a year. The move aims to address the shortage of air defense systems caused by ongoing Russian attacks.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** Patriot Missile System: A mobile surface-to-air missile (SAM) system designed to intercept short, medium, and long-range targets.
- **Fact:** Production timeline: Establishing production capacity for Patriot missiles in Ukraine is expected to take over one year.
- **Post:** Volodymyr Zelensky: President of Ukraine.
- **Post:** Donald Trump: President of the United States.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of advanced air defence systems in modern warfare and the geopolitical implications of technology transfer to conflict zones.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/126169

Jaishankar meets Iranian, Russian Foreign Ministers on UNGA margins

Why in news: External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar met Iranian and Russian counterparts at the 81st UNGA to discuss BRICS cooperation and the Gulf conflict amidst new U.S. sanctions.

Key facts: The meeting took place on September 26, 2026, in New York during the 81st UN General Assembly. Discussions focused on bilateral issues, BRICS cooperation, and the Gulf conflict following new U.S. sanctions on oil and gas purchases from Russia and Iran.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** UNGA: United Nations General Assembly is the main deliberative body of the UN.
- **Fact:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (plus new members).
- **Place:** New York: Host city of the United Nations headquarters.
- **Post:** S. Jaishankar: Current Minister of External Affairs of India.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of India's multi-aligned foreign policy in navigating the complexities of U.S. sanctions and maintaining strategic ties with Russia and Iran.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/126294

U.S. looking to become huge source of India's energy needs: Senior State Department official

Why in news: The U.S. State Department signaled a strategic shift to become a primary energy supplier for India, bolstered by new legislation targeting Russian and Iranian energy imports.

Key facts: The 'Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026' allows for tariffs up to 100% on countries purchasing Russian oil and gas. This legislation aims to redirect global energy flows away from Russia and Iran toward U.S. sources.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** The Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 allows for tariffs up to 100% on Russian oil/gas buyers.
- **Place:** The U.S. State Department is the primary agency overseeing these diplomatic and energy-related shifts.
- **Fact:** India is identified as a key country whose energy diversification is being influenced by these U.S. sanctions.

Mains question: Discuss the implications of U.S. energy diplomacy and sanctions on India's energy security and its strategic autonomy in the global energy market.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/126301](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/126301)

Russia backs India's UN Security Council bid, criticizes Western additions

Why in news: Russia and Mauritius endorsed India's bid for a permanent seat on the UN Security Council while criticizing the inclusion of Western nations like Germany and Japan.

Key facts: Russia's Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov expressed support for India's permanent membership at the 81st UN General Assembly. The statement emphasized broadening representation for the Global South while maintaining the powers of existing permanent members.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** UN Security Council (UNSC): The primary organ of the UN responsible for maintaining international peace and security.
- **Fact:** Current permanent members of the UNSC: China, France, Russia, UK, and USA.
- **Place:** 81st UN General Assembly: Held in New York, USA.
- **Fact:** Global South: A term used to describe developing and underdeveloped nations, particularly in Africa, Asia, and Latin America.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges and geopolitical implications of reforming the UN Security Council to ensure more equitable representation for the Global South.

Source: NDTV · [satyadheesh.in/news/126466](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/126466)

Jaishankar defends India from Pakistan's attacks at UN, calls for reformed global order

Why in news: External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar defended India's stance against state-sponsored terrorism and called for a multi-polar world order during the UN General Assembly.

Key facts: S. Jaishankar delivered India's National Statement at the UNGA on September 26. He addressed Pakistan PM Shehbaz Sharif's allegations regarding Kashmir and the Indus Waters Treaty, emphasizing India's right to self-defense against terrorism.

Prelims pointers

- **Post:** S. Jaishankar: Minister of External Affairs, Government of India
- **Body:** UNGA: United Nations General Assembly, the main policy-making body of the UN
- **Fact:** The 'Four Fs' impacted by global conflicts: Food, Fuel, Fertilizers, and Finance
- **Place:** Global South: A term used to describe developing and underdeveloped nations in the Global South

Mains question: *Discuss India's growing role as a voice for the Global South in advocating for a multi-polar world order and reformed multilateralism at the United Nations.*

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/126476](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/126476)

India's Foreign Secretary Faces U.S. Delegation Over Russia Oil Sanctions Threat

Why in news: India's Foreign Secretary met a U.S. Congressional Delegation to discuss concerns regarding the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctions against Russia and Iran Act (SRIA) and its impact on India's energy imports.

Key facts: The SRIA was passed on September 16, 2026, and mandates sanctions on countries purchasing Russian oil. Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri met with a five-member U.S. Congressional Delegation led by Brian Mast to discuss the implications for India.

Prelims pointers

- **Post:** Vikram Misri: Current Foreign Secretary of India
- **Fact:** SRIA: Lindsey O. Graham Sanctions against Russia and Iran Act passed on September 16, 2026
- **Body:** U.S. Congressional Delegation: Legislative body of the United States

Mains question: *Discuss the challenges India faces in balancing its strategic autonomy with international sanctions regimes regarding energy security.*

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/126841](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/126841)

UAE to invest additional \$25 billion in India, aiming for \$100 billion total

Why in news: The UAE announced a \$25 billion investment in India's infrastructure and technology sectors, aiming to reach a \$100 billion total investment target.

Key facts: The announcement was made by Union Minister Piyush Goyal during the 14th High-Level Joint Task Force meeting. The agreement targets cooperation in ports, shipbuilding, energy security, space technology, and financial services.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** UAE's total investment target in India: \$100 billion
- **Fact:** Target bilateral trade between India and UAE: \$200 billion by 2032
- **Fact:** New investment tranche announced: \$25 billion
- **Fact:** Key sectors for cooperation: Ports, shipbuilding, energy security, space technology, and financial services

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of India's deepening economic and technological ties with the UAE in the context of India's 'Look West' policy and energy security.*

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127405

India, US Trade Deal Faces US Tariff Hurdles; Goyal Heads to Talks

Why in news: Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal is set to visit the US to navigate tariff hurdles and Section 301 issues in the ongoing India-US trade agreement negotiations.

Key facts: External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar stated that while an understanding exists, US tariff policies and the Section 301 process remain key hurdles. The negotiations aim to improve bilateral ties through a formal trade agreement.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Section 301: A US trade law allowing the government to impose tariffs on countries found to engage in unfair trade practices.
- **Post:** Piyush Goyal: Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, India.
- **Post:** S. Jaishankar: Minister of External Affairs, India.

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of trade agreements in strengthening India's bilateral ties with the United States while addressing challenges posed by protectionist tariff policies.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127566

Houthis Capture Yemen Ports with IRGC Help, Control Strategic Strait

Why in news: Houthi rebels captured key Yemeni ports with reported IRGC assistance, threatening maritime security in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait.

Key facts: The Houthi group (Ansar Allah) seized Mocha, Dhubab, and Mayyun Island in September 2024. The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) is alleged to have provided advisory and communication support for the offensive.

Prelims pointers

- **Place:** Bab al-Mandeb Strait: A strategic maritime choke point connecting the Red Sea to the Gulf of Aden.
- **Fact:** Ansar Allah (Houthis): A militant group in Yemen supported by Iran.
- **S&T:** IRGC: The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps is an elite branch of the Iranian Armed Forces.

Mains question: *Analyze the impact of the Houthi-led maritime disruptions on global trade routes and India's energy security.*

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/127741

India Talks with China to Use Xinjiang Airspace; Flights Set to Resume

Why in news: India and China are negotiating the use of Xinjiang airspace as an alternative route for Indian airlines following Pakistan's airspace ban.

Key facts: India is exploring the Hotan route via Xinjiang to bypass Pakistan's airspace restrictions. China Southern Airlines announced the resumption of direct flights between Guangzhou and New Delhi starting September 21.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** China Southern Airlines resumed direct flights between Guangzhou and New Delhi from September 21.
- **Place:** Hotan is a city in the Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region of China.
- **Fact:** IndiGo and Air India have resumed services to China as part of restored air links.

Mains question: *Discuss how the restoration of air connectivity and airspace negotiations between India and China reflect the evolving dynamics of bilateral relations and regional logistics.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127753

Japan urges India to speed up UNICORN radar deal amid Quad naval plans

Why in news: Japan urged India to fast-track the UNICORN naval radar agreement to enhance maritime security and military collaboration under FOIP principles.

Key facts: The UNICORN naval radar agreement was signed during PM Sanae Takaichi's visit in July 2026. Japan also announced plans for Quad naval exercises near the Sea of Japan and revisions to defense documents due to West Asia and Ukraine conflicts.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** FOIP: Free and Open Indo-Pacific is a strategic framework for maritime security and regional cooperation.
- **Fact:** The UNICORN naval radar agreement is a bilateral defense cooperation between India and Japan.
- **Place:** The Sea of Japan is a key maritime zone for Quad naval exercises.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the UNICORN naval radar agreement and the FOIP framework in strengthening India-Japan maritime security cooperation.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127916

Pakistan hosts SCO preparatory meeting; India attends amid Kashmir tensions

Why in news: India participated in an SCO preparatory meeting in Islamabad for the first time since Operation Sindoor, highlighting complex dynamics between multilateral cooperation and bilateral tensions.

Key facts: Pakistan announced it will host the SCO Summit in August 2027. The three-day SCO National Coordinators' meeting began on September 29, 2026, in Islamabad.

Prelims pointers

- **Intl. org:** SCO: Shanghai Cooperation Organisation is a Eurasian political, economic, and security alliance.
- **Fact:** Pakistan is scheduled to host the SCO Summit in August 2027.
- **Place:** Islamabad: Capital of Pakistan where the preparatory meeting was held.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges India faces in balancing multilateral engagements within the SCO while navigating bilateral tensions and security concerns in the region.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127931

US pauses record USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as trade bargaining chip

Why in news: The US paused a record USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan during a summit with China as a trade bargaining chip, signaling a shift in US-China-India dynamics.

Key facts: Donald Trump and Xi Jinping met in Washington to extend a trade truce by two months and establish an agricultural working group. The US paused a USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as part of 'repricing' negotiations with China.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** The US paused a USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as a bargaining chip during negotiations with China.
- **Fact:** The US and China extended their trade truce by two months following the Washington summit.
- **Place:** Donald Trump is scheduled to visit China for the APEC summit in November 2025.
- **Place:** Xi Jinping is scheduled to attend the G20 summit in Miami in December 2025.
- **Fact:** India faced a 50% tariff hike on its goods by the US in August 2025.

Mains question: *Analyze how the shift in US-China relations towards 'managed competition' impacts India's strategic autonomy and its position in the Indo-Pacific region.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128416

Modi and Trump review trade, defence, energy and critical technology cooperation

Why in news: Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Donald Trump held a high-level discussion to review and strengthen the India-US Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership across trade, defence, and technology.

Key facts: The leaders discussed cooperation in four key pillars: trade, defence, energy, and critical technology. The dialogue aimed to advance global peace and security while benefiting the populations of both nations.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: The overarching framework for India-US bilateral relations.
- **Post:** Narendra Modi: Prime Minister of India.
- **Post:** Donald Trump: President of the United States.

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of the India-US Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership in shaping the geopolitical landscape of the Indo-Pacific region.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128501

Economy

Capital markets & SEBI · Prelims · 12 Sept

SEBI Proposes Major Changes: New Settlement Prices, Market Timings Up for Debate

Why in news: SEBI has proposed new methodologies for determining expiry-day settlement prices for index and stock derivatives to improve market functioning.

Key facts: SEBI proposed two options: 'Blended VWAP' (combining last 30 mins of CTS and 10 mins of CAS) and 'CTS VWAP' (only last 30 mins of CTS). Public comments are invited by October 3, 2026.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India) is the primary regulator for the securities market in India.
- **Fact:** Blended VWAP option includes trades from the last 30 minutes of Continuous Trading Session (CTS) and 10 minutes of Call Auction Session (CAS).
- **Fact:** CTS VWAP option relies solely on the last 30 minutes of the Continuous Trading Session (CTS).
- **Fact:** The proposal includes restrictions on order cancellations during the Call Auction Session (CAS).

Mains question: Discuss the significance of settlement price methodologies in ensuring market integrity and liquidity in the Indian derivatives market.

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/120771

Capital markets & SEBI · Prelims + Mains · 12 Sept

Sebi's Demat 2.0 pilot raises ₹1,025 crore in tokenised bond sales

Why in news: SEBI launched the Demat 2.0 pilot for tokenised corporate bonds to leverage Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) for faster settlement and automated payments.

Key facts: The pilot involved three companies—REC, L&T, and IIFL—raising a total of ₹1,025 crore. The system utilizes Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) and the RBI's e-rupee to automate interest and redemption payments while eliminating settlement risk.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** SEBI: Securities and Exchange Board of India, the regulator for the securities market.
- **S&T:** DLT: Distributed Ledger Technology, a decentralized digital ledger that records transactions across multiple nodes.
- **Fact:** Demat 2.0 pilot successfully facilitated the sale of tokenised bonds worth ₹1,025 crore.
- **S&T:** e-rupee: The Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) issued by the Reserve Bank of India.

Mains question: Discuss how the integration of Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) and Central Bank Digital Currencies (CBDC) can enhance the efficiency and transparency of India's capital markets.

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/120787

On Monday, September 14, 2026, India notified changes to the Payment

Why in news: The Government of India notified amendments to the Payment and Settlement Act, 2007, prohibiting banks from charging fees on UPI transactions up to ₹2,000 and RuPay debit card payments.

Key facts: The notification specifies that no bank or system provider can impose direct or indirect charges on UPI transactions up to ₹2,000 or RuPay-powered debit card payments. The amendment clarifies these as protected electronic modes of payment, while the policy on charges for larger transfers remains pending.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Payment and Settlement Act, 2007: The primary legislation governing electronic payment systems in India.
- **Fact:** UPI transaction limit for zero-charge mandate: ₹2,000.
- **Fact:** RuPay debit cards are specifically included in the zero-charge notification.
- **Body:** UPI (Unified Payments Interface): An instant real-time payment system developed by NPCI.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) in promoting financial inclusion and the implications of regulating transaction charges on the digital economy.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/121786

New 0.4% Charge on Transactions Above ₹2,000 Caps Merchant Costs at ₹300

Why in news: The Indian government and NPCI introduced a new UPI Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) framework to balance digital payment innovation with merchant costs.

Key facts: Effective October 15, a 0.4% charge applies to merchant transactions exceeding ₹2,000, capped at ₹300 per transaction. Person-to-person (P2P) and Person-to-Merchant (P2M) transactions up to ₹2,000 remain free of charge.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** UPI MDR: 0.4% charge on merchant transactions above ₹2,000
- **Fact:** Transaction Cap: Merchant costs capped at ₹300 per transaction
- **Body:** NPCI: National Payments Corporation of India, the umbrella organization for retail payments in India
- **Fact:** Free Transactions: P2P and P2M transactions up to ₹2,000 remain free

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the UPI framework in promoting financial inclusion and the challenges of balancing merchant costs with digital payment scalability.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/122149

Paytm shares plummet after government RuPay, UPI fee move

Why in news: Paytm shares plummeted following a government notification exempting RuPay/UPI transactions up to ₹2,000 from charges while paving the way for future Merchant Discount Rates (MDR).

Key facts: The government issued a gazette notification following an amendment to the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007. The move exempts charges on RuPay/UPI transactions up to ₹2,000 but allows for future MDRs on higher-value transactions to ensure system sustainability.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007: Provides the framework for MDR on electronic payment modes.
- **Fact:** Current exemption: No charges on RuPay/UPI transactions up to ₹2,000.
- **Fact:** Paytm share price volatility: Hit a 52-week high of ₹1,840 before dropping to ₹1,761.80.
- **Body:** MDR (Merchant Discount Rate): A fee paid by merchants to banks/payment providers for processing transactions.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges of creating a self-sustaining revenue model for India's digital payment infrastructure while ensuring financial inclusion.

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/122153

July Capital Account Surplus Reverses First Quarter Deficit at \$27.7 Billion

Why in news: India's capital account recorded a \$27.7 billion surplus in July, reversing the first-quarter deficit driven by RBI's dollar-mobilisation programme.

Key facts: The capital account surplus for April-July reached \$23.9 billion, a significant jump from \$11.4 billion in the previous year. While FDI and portfolio investments were positive (\$7.3B and \$4.1B respectively), the merchandise trade deficit rose to \$117.8 billion for the first four months of the fiscal year.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Capital account surplus in July: \$27.7 billion
- **Fact:** FDI inflows in July: \$7.3 billion
- **Fact:** Merchandise trade deficit (April-July): \$117.8 billion
- **Fact:** Portfolio investments in July: \$4.1 billion (positive)

Mains question: Analyze the factors contributing to India's capital account surplus and the persistent challenge of a widening merchandise trade deficit.

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/122332

UPI hits merchants: New 0.4% fee on P2M transactions over ₹2,000 capped at ₹300

Why in news: NPCI is introducing a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on high-value UPI transactions to sustain the payment infrastructure and security costs.

Key facts: Starting October 15, a 0.4% MDR will apply to P2M transactions over ₹2,000, capped at ₹300 for amounts exceeding ₹75,000. In FY26, UPI handled 24,162 crore transactions, with P2M payments accounting for 63% of the volume.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** UPI handled 24,162 crore transactions in FY26.
- **Fact:** P2M transactions above ₹2,000 account for 66% of the total UPI transaction value.
- **Fact:** The new MDR is 0.4% for P2M transactions over ₹2,000, capped at ₹300.
- **Fact:** P2P (Person-to-Person) payments remain free under the new structure.

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) in formalizing India's digital economy and the challenges of sustaining its infrastructure through transaction fees.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/122548

EPFO Wage Ceiling Hiked to ₹25,000, Covering 51 Lakh More Workers

Why in news: The Union Cabinet approved a significant hike in the EPFO wage ceiling to ₹25,000 to expand social security coverage to more workers.

Key facts: The EPFO wage ceiling is increasing from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000 effective September 17, 2026. This move covers 51 lakh additional employees and will increase the annual government outgo by ₹11,339 crore.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** New EPFO wage ceiling: ₹25,000
- **Fact:** Additional workers covered: 51 lakh
- **Fact:** Annual government outgo increase: ₹11,339 crore
- **Fact:** Employer contribution increase: ₹600 per employee

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of expanding social security coverage for the unorganized and formal workforce in India's quest for inclusive growth.*

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/122558

Supreme Court Petition Challenges 0.4% UPI Charge for Big Transactions

Why in news: A petition was filed in the Supreme Court challenging the constitutional validity of a 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions exceeding ₹2,000.

Key facts: The petition challenges the amendment to Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007. The government intends to impose a 0.4% charge on merchants for UPI transactions over ₹2,000 starting October 15, 2026.

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007: Governs the framework for electronic payment systems in India.
- **Fact:** The proposed MDR (Merchant Discount Rate) is 0.4% for UPI transactions exceeding ₹2,000.
- **Body:** UPI (Unified Payments Interface): A real-time payment system developed by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI).

Mains question: Discuss the implications of imposing Merchant Discount Rates (MDR) on digital payment systems for the growth of the formal economy and small businesses in India.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/122562

Indian PM Urges Industry: "Skill and Innovate" at Semicon India 2026

Why in news: PM Modi urged industry leaders to focus on skilling and innovation at Semicon India 2026 to bolster India's semiconductor manufacturing ecosystem.

Key facts: Kaynes Technology is establishing a ₹3,307 crore facility in Gujarat. The event highlights India's semiconductor value chain, covering everything from design to systems.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Kaynes Technology is investing ₹3,307 crore in a semiconductor facility in Gujarat.
- **S&T:** Semicon India 2026 showcases the full semiconductor value chain including design and systems.
- **Fact:** Stock gains at Semicon India 2026: Syrma SGS Technology (10%), MosChip Technologies (6%), and Kaynes Technology (5%).

Mains question: Discuss the significance of developing a robust semiconductor manufacturing ecosystem for India's economic sovereignty and technological advancement.

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/122730

Modi's reforms boost India's economy to over \$4 trillion, but job creation lags

Why in news: The article highlights India's economic trajectory under 'Modinomics', noting the transition from a 'Fragile Five' economy to a \$4 trillion+ economy through structural reforms.

Key facts: India's nominal GDP grew from ~\$2 trillion in 2014 to over \$4 trillion currently. Key drivers include a 7.5% average GDP growth, GST implementation, UPI expansion, and Production Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India's nominal GDP crossed the \$4 trillion mark as of the current period.
- **Fact:** India's real GDP growth was recorded at 7.8% in the April-June quarter of FY27.
- **Scheme:** PLI (Production Linked Incentive) schemes are used to boost domestic manufacturing.
- **Fact:** India was previously categorized among the 'Fragile Five' emerging markets.

Mains question: Critically analyze the impact of structural reforms like GST and PLI schemes on India's journey toward becoming a \$5 trillion economy.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/122896

On India's Semiconductor Aspirations, Ashwini Vaishnaw's Progress Report

Why in news: Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw reported significant progress in India's semiconductor manufacturing and design ecosystem during the Semicon India event.

Key facts: India has approved 12 semiconductor plants, with 5 already operational. The government has successfully trained 70,000 design engineers to support the domestic electronics manufacturing hub.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** 5 out of 12 approved semiconductor plants in India are currently operational.
- **Fact:** India has trained 70,000 design engineers for the semiconductor sector.
- **Place:** Semicon India event was held in New Delhi.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of developing a domestic semiconductor ecosystem for India's economic sovereignty and technological advancement.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/123265

First-Ever District-Level Jobs Data Reveals Wide Gaps In Female Workforce Participation

Why in news: The National Statistical Office (NSO) released India's first district-level labour market estimates under the revamped Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), highlighting significant regional disparities in female workfor...

Key facts: The NSO released the first district-level labour market estimates under the revamped PLFS. Surat recorded the highest LFPR (68.6%) and WPR (67.8%), while female LFPR varied drastically from 80.9% in Hamirpur to 18.9% in East Delhi.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** NSO: National Statistical Office is the primary body responsible for collecting and compiling official statistics in India.
- **Fact:** PLFS: Periodic Labour Force Survey is the primary source for estimating employment and unemployment data in India.
- **Fact:** Surat recorded the highest LFPR (68.6%) and WPR (67.8%) in the district-level data.
- **Fact:** East Delhi recorded a significantly low female LFPR of 18.9%.

Mains question: *Analyze the factors contributing to the wide regional disparities in female workforce participation in India and suggest measures to enhance women's economic inclusion.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/123538

Aadhaar Biometric Authentication Must For Subsidised LPG Refills From October

Why in news: The government is mandating biometric Aadhaar authentication for subsidized LPG refills from October 1 to curb subsidy leakage and ensure targeted delivery.

Key facts: As of September 19, 89.9% of domestic LPG consumers had completed biometric authentication. The move aims to address accumulated subsidy losses exceeding Rs 62,000 crore as of August 31, 2024.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** 89.9% of domestic LPG consumers had completed biometric authentication as of September 19.
- **Fact:** Accumulated subsidy losses exceeded Rs 62,000 crore as of August 31, 2024.
- **Body:** Aadhaar is a voluntary civil identity program managed by UIDAI.

Mains question: *Discuss how the integration of biometric authentication and Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) mechanisms helps in optimizing fiscal prudence and ensuring targeted subsidy delivery in India.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/123761

HAL shares rise 2% as firm hands over 3 aerospace platforms to IAF. What is Goldman Sachs saying?

Why in news: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) handed over three key aerospace platforms (Dhruv-NG, LCA FOC Trainer, and HTT-40) to the IAF, marking a milestone in indigenous defense manufacturing.

Key facts: HAL delivered the first HTT-40 Basic Trainer (tandem-seat, Honeywell turboprop engine) and the final batch of LCA FOC Trainer aircraft to the IAF. Additionally, four Dhruv-NG helicopters were handed over to Pawan Hans Limited after receiving DGCA Type Certification.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** HTT-40: A tandem-seat, fully aerobatic basic trainer powered by a Honeywell turboprop engine.
- **Fact:** HAL is producing 70 HTT-40 aircraft under contract to replace the ageing HPT-32 Deepak fleet.
- **S&T:** LCA FOC Trainer: The twin-seat version of the indigenous Tejas fighter used for advanced combat flight training.
- **S&T:** Dhruv-NG: Next-generation civil version of HAL's Advanced Light Helicopter for offshore and passenger operations.

Mains question: Discuss how the promotion of indigenous aerospace manufacturing contributes to India's 'Atmanirbhar Bharat' initiative and its strategic autonomy in defense.

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/124463

RBI issues norms on capital requirements for market risk under Basel III for banks

Why in news: RBI issued new norms to align market risk capital requirements with Basel III standards to ensure banking stability.

Key facts: The RBI directions apply to all commercial banks except small finance, payments, and local area banks. The new norms come into effect from April 1, 2027, and require banks to use the Standardized Approach (SSA) for computing risk-weighted assets (RWAs).

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** RBI: The central bank of India responsible for monetary policy and banking regulation.
- **Fact:** Basel III: A global, voluntary regulatory framework on bank capital adequacy, stress testing, and market liquidity risks.
- **Fact:** The new norms require a factor of 12.5 for computing risk-weighted assets (RWAs) under the SSA.
- **Fact:** Exemptions: Small finance banks, payments banks, and local area banks are excluded from these specific market risk norms.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the Basel III framework in ensuring the stability of the Indian banking sector and preventing systemic risks.

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/124559

S&P Global Ratings Raises India's GDP Growth Projections To 7% For This Fiscal

Why in news: S&P Global Ratings upgraded India's GDP growth projection to 7% for the current fiscal year due to robust industrial activity and government investment.

Key facts: S&P Global Ratings projected a 7% GDP growth for India's current fiscal year. The agency also forecasted a 25 basis point interest rate hike by the RBI in FY27 and estimated consumer inflation at 5.1%.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** S&P Global Ratings projected India's GDP growth at 7% for the current fiscal year.
- **Fact:** RBI is projected to hike interest rates by 25 basis points in FY27.
- **Fact:** S&P estimates consumer inflation at 5.1%.
- **Body:** S&P Global Ratings is a leading international credit rating agency.

Mains question: *Analyze the factors contributing to India's robust economic growth and discuss the potential risks posed by climate-related variables on the manufacturing and agricultural sectors.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/125123

Sebi approves new rules to widen investment avenues

Why in news: SEBI introduced the PRIM (Portfolio Manager Investment Route) to allow portfolio managers to invest client funds in mutual fund direct plans and other instruments to broaden investment avenues.

Key facts: The PRIM framework allows investments in mutual fund direct plans, ETFs, and index funds with a minimum ticket size of ₹25 lakh. Management fees are capped at 1% of Assets Under Management (AUM), and independent fund managers can operate under registered portfolio managers' supervision.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** SEBI: The primary regulator of the securities and commodity markets in India.
- **Fact:** Minimum ticket size for PRIM: ₹25 lakh.
- **Fact:** Management fee cap: 1% of AUM.
- **S&T:** PRIM allows investment in IPOs, primary debt, exchange-traded derivatives, and foreign securities (up to 10% of AUM).

Mains question: *Discuss how the expansion of investment avenues through regulatory reforms like PRIM can enhance retail participation in capital markets and promote financial inclusion.*

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/125859

Sebi Approves PMS Rules, Expanding Portfolio Advisors' Roles

Why in news: SEBI approved new Portfolio Management Services (PMS) rules to expand the scope of investment options available to portfolio advisors.

Key facts: SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India) has updated regulations to allow portfolio advisors to offer a broader range of investment products. The move aims to enhance investor choice and streamline the investment landscape for retail and high-net-worth individuals.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** SEBI: Statutory body established to regulate the securities and commodity markets in India.
- **Fact:** Rupee strengthened to 95.90 against the US dollar during the reporting period.
- **Fact:** Projected net employment changes for e-commerce and tech startups are 12.6% and 12.3% respectively.

Mains question: Discuss how the expansion of Portfolio Management Services (PMS) rules by SEBI contributes to deepening the Indian capital markets and enhancing investor protection.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/125879

IRDAI proposes changes to cap insurance commissions and restrict bundling

Why in news: IRDAI proposed capping insurance commissions and restricting loan-insurance bundling to enhance transparency and reduce costs for consumers.

Key facts: The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) proposed limits on agent/broker commissions and lower expense ratios for insurers. The proposal also seeks to curb the practice of bundling insurance products with loan disbursements.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** IRDAI: The statutory body regulating the insurance sector in India
- **Fact:** Proposed measures include caps on commissions and lower expense limits for insurers
- **Fact:** Bundling of insurance with loans is a key area of proposed restriction

Mains question: Discuss how regulatory measures on insurance commissions and bundling can balance consumer protection with the growth of insurance penetration in rural India.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/125988

Shah, Patel launch India's first LNG-powered train after 2,000 km trials

Why in news: The launch of India's first LNG-powered train marks a shift towards cleaner, dual-fuel propulsion in the railway sector to reduce carbon footprint.

Key facts: The train utilizes a diesel-plus-LNG dual-fuel system in two 1,400 HP Driving Power Cars (DPCs). Each DPC features an LNG tank with a capacity of 850-900 kg of usable LNG, capable of replacing up to 40% of diesel fuel.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** LNG-powered train trial covered over 2,000 km before official launch.
- **Fact:** The dual-fuel system reduces fuel costs and emissions by up to 40% compared to pure diesel.
- **Fact:** The initiative is part of a railway infrastructure project valued at Rs 1,542 crore.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of transitioning to LNG-powered rail transport in achieving India's net-zero emission targets and improving railway operational efficiency.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/126616

Rupee Hits Record Low, RBI Interventions Cost \$14.8 Billion

Why in news: The RBI's intervention to stabilize the Indian Rupee against a strengthening US Dollar led to a significant reduction in foreign exchange reserves.

Key facts: The Indian Rupee hit a record low in May 2025. The RBI's intervention to curb depreciation resulted in a reduction of \$14.8 billion in its reserves. Experts noted a negative balance of payments excluding foreign currency inflows.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** RBI: The central bank of India responsible for monetary policy and managing foreign exchange reserves.
- **Fact:** The RBI's reserves were reduced by \$14.8 billion due to currency interventions.
- **Fact:** The rupee's depreciation was noted to have potentially overcorrected by up to 13%.

Mains question: *Analyze the impact of a strengthening US Dollar on India's balance of payments and the role of the RBI in managing currency volatility.*

Source: Economic Times · satyadheesh.in/news/126899

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) introduced the Telecom Consumer Protection (Thirteenth Amendment) Regulations

Why in news: TRAI introduced the Telecom Consumer Protection (Thirteenth Amendment) Regulations, 2026, to mandate voice and SMS-only plans with proportional tariff reductions to lower consumer costs.

Key facts: The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) issued the Thirteenth Amendment Regulations in 2026. The regulations require telecom operators to offer plans with validity periods aligned with monthly expectations and proportional tariff reductions for voice/SMS-only options.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** TRAI: An independent statutory body established to regulate the telecommunications sector in India.
- **Fact:** The Thirteenth Amendment Regulations, 2026, mandate proportional tariff reductions for voice and SMS-only plans.
- **Fact:** The regulations aim to align plan validity periods with monthly consumer usage expectations.

Mains question: *Discuss how regulatory interventions by bodies like TRAI can balance the interests of telecom service providers and consumer welfare in a digital economy.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127028

Supreme Court Rejects Plea to Halt 0.4% UPI Charge on Big Transactions

Why in news: The Supreme Court questioned the legal status of the 0.4% UPI merchant discount rate (MDR) as a potential 'expropriation' and its impact on the formal economy.

Key facts: The government proposed a 0.4% charge on UPI person-to-merchant transactions exceeding ₹2,000 starting October 15, 2026. The Supreme Court has sought counter affidavits from the Union of India, RBI, and NPCI regarding the legality and economic impact of this levy.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India) is the primary body for operating the UPI infrastructure.
- **Fact:** The proposed UPI Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) is 0.4% for transactions above ₹2,000.
- **Body:** RBI (Reserve Bank of India) is the regulatory authority for the Indian payment systems.

Mains question: Discuss the implications of imposing Merchant Discount Rates (MDR) on UPI transactions on the growth of a cashless economy and the potential for informalization.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/127109](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/127109)

India Aims for 10 GW Polysilicon by August to Cut China Dependence

Why in news: The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy is developing an incentive scheme to boost domestic polysilicon production to reduce India's heavy reliance on Chinese imports.

Key facts: India currently has over 213 GW of solar module manufacturing capacity and 32 GW of cell capacity. The government aims for 10 GW of polysilicon production by August and a target of 30 GW by 2030.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India's current solar module manufacturing capacity exceeds 213 GW.
- **Fact:** Target for domestic polysilicon production is 30 GW by 2030.
- **Body:** Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) is the nodal ministry for solar incentives.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of developing a domestic solar supply chain in India to achieve energy security and reduce import dependencies.

Source: NDTV · [satyadheesh.in/news/128134](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128134)

Centre notifies CAFE-3 norms: Fuel benchmark to drop 16.7% by 2031-32

Why in news: The Centre notified CAFE-3 norms for passenger vehicles to mandate a 16.7% reduction in fuel consumption benchmarks by 2031-32 to promote cleaner automotive technologies.

Key facts: The CAFE-3 norms apply to all new passenger vehicles manufactured or imported for sale in India starting April 1, 2027. The benchmark drops from 3.996 litres/100 km in 2027-28 to 3.3273 litres/100 km by 2031-32. The reference weight for calculations is increased from 1,082 kg to 1,229 kg.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** CAFE-3 fuel benchmark: 3.3273 litres per 100 km by 2031-32
- **Fact:** Reference weight increase: From 1,082 kg to 1,229 kg under CAFE-3
- **S&T:** Carbon Neutrality Factor (CNF): A mechanism providing concessions for eligible cleaner technologies
- **Fact:** Implementation period: April 1, 2027, to March 31, 2032

Mains question: Discuss how the CAFE-3 norms align with India's commitment to decarbonizing the transport sector while balancing industrial growth and technological adoption.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128231

India to become "super-aged" by 2065 as fertility rate hits 1.9

Why in news: A Moody's report warns that India's rapid fertility decline (1.9) will lead to a 'super-aged' demographic status by 2065, posing a risk of aging before achieving high-income status.

Key facts: India's Total Fertility Rate (TFR) is currently 1.9, dropping to 1.6 if Bihar and Uttar Pradesh are excluded. The report projects India will transition from 'aged' in 2049 to 'super-aged' by 2065, a much faster transition than the US or Indonesia.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India's current Total Fertility Rate (TFR) is 1.9.
- **Fact:** India is projected to become 'super-aged' by the year 2065.
- **Fact:** Annual births in India have dropped to 2.32 crore.
- **Fact:** Replacement level fertility is generally considered to be 2.1 children per woman.

Mains question: Discuss the economic implications of India's rapidly aging demographic profile and the necessity of increasing female labor force participation to sustain growth.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128332

Modi's Union Cabinet approves ₹1,86,405 crore for Green Energy Corridor Phase-III scheme

Why in news: The Union Cabinet approved the 'Green Energy Corridor Phase-III' scheme with a ₹1,86,405 crore outlay to facilitate the evacuation of renewable energy and enhance storage capacity.

Key facts: The scheme allocates ₹1,36,378 crore for Intra-State Transmission Systems and ₹50,000 crore for 50 GWh of Battery Energy Storage Systems. It aims to evacuate 135 GW of renewable energy by FY 2032-33 to support India's 500 GW renewable target by 2030.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Total outlay for Green Energy Corridor Phase-III: ₹1,86,405 crore
- **Fact:** Target for renewable energy evacuation: 135 GW by FY 2032-33
- **Fact:** Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) target: 50 GWh
- **Fact:** India's non-fossil fuel capacity target: 900 GW by 2035

Mains question: *Examine how the development of Green Energy Corridors and Battery Energy Storage Systems is essential for achieving India's ambitious non-fossil fuel capacity targets by 2035.*

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/128352](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128352)

Agriculture

Modi cabinet approves rabi crop MSP hikes with ₹90,962 crore farmer payout

Why in news: The Union Cabinet approved increased Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for six Rabi crops for the 2027-28 marketing year to ensure farmer profitability.

Key facts: The Cabinet approved a total farmer payout of ₹90,962 crore for 324 lakh tonnes of produce. The MSP for wheat was hiked by ₹25 per quintal to ₹2,610, while masur saw a significant hike of ₹390 per quintal.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Wheat MSP for 2027-28 rabi marketing year: ₹2,610 per quintal
- **Fact:** Masur MSP for 2027-28 rabi marketing year: ₹7,390 per quintal
- **Body:** CACP (Commission for Agricultural Costs & Prices) provides recommendations for MSP fixing
- **Fact:** Total estimated farmer payout for 2027-28 rabi crops: ₹90,962 crore
- **Fact:** Wheat production target for 2026-27 crop year: 121 million tonnes

Mains question: *Critically examine the role of Minimum Support Price (MSP) in ensuring food security and farmer welfare while addressing the fiscal implications on the national exchequer.*

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/128358](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128358)

Science & Technology

IT, AI, semiconductors & computing · Prelims + Mains · 3 Sept

20 million children globally face online sexual abuse, UNICEF reports

Why in news: UNICEF released a report highlighting that 20 million children globally face online sexual abuse, emphasizing the urgent need for AI-driven safety measures and legal reforms.

Key facts: The UNICEF report covers 21 countries where 20 million internet-using children faced online sexual exploitation. Key platforms identified include Facebook and WhatsApp, with fewer than 1% of cases reported to authorities.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** UNICEF: United Nations Children's Fund, a UN agency responsible for providing humanitarian and developmental assistance to children.
- **Fact:** Over one in five children aged 12 to 17 were affected by online sexual exploitation in the studied regions.
- **S&T:** AI-generated sexual content is identified as a growing threat to child safety in digital spaces.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges in regulating online safety for children in the era of AI-generated content and suggest measures to mitigate online sexual exploitation.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/116973

Space technology (ISRO, missions) · Prelims · 4 Sept

India Launches EOS-05: First Imaging Satellite in Geosynchronous Orbit at 2:55 AM

Why in news: ISRO launched EOS-05, India's first imaging satellite in Geosynchronous orbit, using the GSLV-F17 rocket.

Key facts: The EOS-05 satellite was launched from the second launch pad at Satish Dhawan Space Centre near Chennai. The mission utilized the GSLV-F17 rocket, which stands 51.7 meters tall, following a 27-hour countdown.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** EOS-05: India's first imaging satellite in Geosynchronous orbit
- **S&T:** GSLV: Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle, a heavy-lift rocket developed by ISRO
- **Place:** Satish Dhawan Space Centre: Located in Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh (near Chennai)
- **Fact:** GSLV-F17 height: 51.7 meters

Mains question: Discuss the significance of achieving imaging capabilities in Geosynchronous orbit for India's space-based surveillance and disaster management capabilities.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/117286

He Won the Nobel Prize for Protein Design. Now He Uses AI to Create Molecules Not Found in Nature

Why in news: David Baker, 2024 Nobel Prize winner, is leveraging AI-driven protein design to create synthetic molecules for medicine and environmental cleanup.

Key facts: The AI BioDesign initiative, led by the Allen Institute, uses AI to design molecules not found in nature. It targets applications such as treating cancer, neurodegenerative disorders, and degrading ocean plastics.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** David Baker won the 2024 Nobel Prize in Chemistry for protein design.
- **Body:** The Allen Institute is a key collaborator in the AI BioDesign project.
- **S&T:** AI BioDesign uses computational screening and lab testing to mitigate risks of synthetic molecules.

Mains question: Discuss the potential of AI-driven biotechnology in revolutionizing healthcare and environmental sustainability while addressing the ethical risks of synthetic molecule creation.

Source: Wired · satyadheesh.in/news/123216

HAL Hands Over Indigenous Tejas Twin-Seater, HTT-40 Aircraft To Air Force

Why in news: HAL handed over indigenous LCA Tejas twin-seater trainers, HTT-40 basic trainers, and Dhruv NG helicopters to the IAF and Pawan Hans, marking a milestone in India's 'Atmanirbhar Bharat' in aerospace.

Key facts: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) delivered LCA Tejas Final Operational Clearance (FOC) twin-seater trainers and HTT-40 (Ankur) basic trainers. The HTT-40 is part of a 70-aircraft contract, while Dhruv next-generation helicopters were handed over to Pawan Hans for civil aviation.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** HTT-40 (Ankur): An indigenous basic trainer aircraft developed by HAL.
- **S&T:** LCA Tejas FOC: The Final Operational Clearance version of India's indigenous Light Combat Aircraft.
- **Post:** Rajnath Singh: Union Minister of Defence.
- **Fact:** HTT-40 Contract: HAL is scheduled to deliver 70 aircraft under this specific contract.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of indigenous aerospace manufacturing in achieving India's goal of self-reliance in defense and civil aviation.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/123277

HAL hands over two LCA trainer plane to Air Force

Why in news: HAL handed over two LCA trainer planes and other aviation platforms to the IAF and Pawan Hans, marking the completion of a 2010 contract and the start of new deliveries.

Key facts: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) delivered two Light Combat Aircraft (LCA) trainers to the Indian Air Force (IAF) and four Dhruv Next Generation helicopters to Pawan Hans Limited. The HTT-40 basic trainer aircraft delivery marks the beginning of a 70-aircraft delivery cycle.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** HAL (Hindustan Aeronautics Limited) is a public sector undertaking under the Ministry of Defence.
- **Fact:** The LCA trainer deliveries were completed under a contract signed in 2010.
- **S&T:** HTT-40 is a basic trainer aircraft being inducted into the IAF.
- **Fact:** Pawan Hans Limited is the recipient of the Dhruv Next Generation helicopters for civilian roles.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of the 'Make in India' initiative in strengthening India's aerospace manufacturing capabilities and self-reliance in defence technology.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/123461

Developing El Niño becomes strongest on record weeks before expected peak

Why in news: Scientists reported that the developing El Niño has reached a record-breaking sea surface temperature, impacting global weather patterns including the Indian monsoon.

Key facts: On September 19, Pacific Ocean sea surface temperatures reached 3.05°C above average, surpassing the 2015 record of 3.02°C. The phenomenon is expected to peak later this year, affecting global rainfall and hurricane activity.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** El Niño: A climate pattern characterized by the unusual warming of surface waters in the eastern tropical Pacific Ocean.
- **Fact:** Current record sea surface temperature: 3.05°C above average (as of Sept 19).
- **Fact:** Previous record: 3.02°C recorded in 2015.
- **S&T:** Impact on India: El Niño is often associated with reduced monsoon rainfall.

Mains question: Discuss the impact of El Niño and La Niña on global climate patterns and suggest measures to mitigate their effects on agricultural productivity in India.

Source: BBC · satyadheesh.in/news/124817

OpenAI, Anthropic CEOs call for global AI regulation at UN

Why in news: CEOs of OpenAI and Anthropic urged the UN Security Council to establish global AI regulations to mitigate existential risks and protect human rights.

Key facts: The UN General Assembly passed its first resolution on AI in 2024 focusing on data protection and human rights. Major tech firms like OpenAI and Anthropic are advocating for international frameworks amidst geopolitical competition between the US and China.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** OpenAI and Anthropic are leading private companies in the development of Generative AI and Large Language Models (LLMs).
- **Intl. org:** The UN General Assembly passed its first resolution on AI in 2024.
- **Fact:** The UN Security Council meeting on AI was convened by France.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges in establishing a global regulatory framework for Artificial Intelligence amidst geopolitical competition and technological sovereignty.

Source: Al Jazeera · satyadheesh.in/news/125474

India's Defence Secretary Reveals AI Spine for Future Warfare Capabilities

Why in news: Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh announced the development of an 'AI spine' to enhance Indian armed forces' warfare capabilities and the establishment of a Defence AI Council.

Key facts: The Indian armed forces are developing an 'AI spine' for future warfare, with the Navy proceeding independently and the Army partnering with industry firms. India abandoned plans to collaborate with Palantir due to data sensitivity concerns and established a research center for quantum capabilities.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** AI Spine: A strategic initiative to integrate Artificial Intelligence into the core of Indian military operations.
- **Body:** Defence AI Council: A body established to oversee and coordinate AI integration in the Indian Armed Forces.
- **S&T:** Quantum Capabilities: India is establishing a dedicated research center for quantum technologies in defence.
- **Fact:** Operation Sindoor: The initial operation where early AI applications were tested by the Indian armed forces.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of integrating Artificial Intelligence and Quantum technologies in modern warfare and the challenges of data sovereignty in military technology.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/126644

India to Buy 114 Rafales for Rs 3.25 Lakh Crore Amid Tejas Delays

Why in news: India is negotiating a ₹3.25 lakh crore deal for 114 Rafale jets to address squadron shortages caused by delays in indigenous Tejas production.

Key facts: The Defence Secretary announced a potential acquisition of 114 Rafale jets valued at ₹3.25 lakh crore. Deliveries are expected to commence from both French production lines and Indian lines by 2030-31.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** Rafale: A multi-role, twin-engine fighter aircraft manufactured by Dassault Aviation.
- **S&T:** Tejas Mk-1A and Mk-2: Indigenous Light Combat Aircraft (LCA) developed by HAL.
- **Fact:** Proposed deal value: ₹3.25 lakh crore for 114 aircraft.
- **Body:** Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL): India's public sector undertaking responsible for aircraft manufacturing.

Mains question: Discuss the challenges and strategic importance of balancing indigenous defense manufacturing with the acquisition of advanced foreign military hardware in India.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127073

HAL Excluded: Defence Ministry Picks Private Firms for AMCA Prototypes

Why in news: Defence Secretary RK Singh revealed that HAL was excluded from the AMCA prototype manufacturing project for the first time due to technical grounds, shifting focus toward private sector participation.

Key facts: The Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA) project involves three selected bidders: Tata Advanced Systems Limited, an L&T-BEL-Dynamatic consortium, and a Bharat Forge-BEML-Data Patterns consortium. The first flight of the AMCA prototype is scheduled for September 2028.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** AMCA: India's indigenous Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft project.
- **Fact:** First flight of the AMCA prototype is expected in September 2028.
- **Body:** HAL: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited is a public sector undertaking under the Ministry of Defence.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of involving the private sector in the manufacturing of advanced indigenous defence technologies like the AMCA for India's self-reliance.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127190

ISRO and CNES are preparing to launch TRISHNA from Sriharikota in 2027

Why in news: ISRO and France's CNES are collaborating to launch the TRISHNA satellite in 2027 to map Earth's water resources and monitor the global water cycle.

Key facts: TRISHNA (Thermal infraRed Imaging Satellite for High-resolution Natural resource Assessment) will provide a resolution better than 60 metres from a Sun-synchronous orbit above 700 km. CNES provides the thermal infrared instrument, while ISRO develops the optical payload.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** TRISHNA: A joint satellite mission by ISRO (India) and CNES (France) scheduled for 2027.
- **S&T:** TRISHNA's Orbit: Operates in a Sun-synchronous orbit at an altitude of more than 700 km.
- **Fact:** TRISHNA Resolution: Aims to deliver a resolution better than 60 metres with multiple revisits per week.
- **S&T:** Vikas Engine: India's major rockets carry a French legacy through the Viking engine, which was transformed into the Vikas engine.

Mains question: Discuss how space-based remote sensing technologies can contribute to achieving Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) related to water security and climate change mitigation.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127237

Kaveri Derivative Engine Exceeds Target, Reaches 48.5 kN Thrust in Russian Trials

Why in news: DRDO's Kaveri Derivative Engine (KDE) exceeded its thrust target during high-altitude flight trials in Russia, marking a milestone for India's indigenous UCAV propulsion.

Key facts: The KDE was developed by the Gas Turbine Research Establishment (GTRE) for the Ghatak Unmanned Combat Aerial Vehicle (UCAV). It achieved a peak dry thrust of 48.5 kN during trials at the CIAM and Gromov Flight Research Institute in Russia.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** GTRE: Gas Turbine Research Establishment is a DRDO laboratory specializing in gas turbine engines.
- **S&T:** KDE: Kaveri Derivative Engine is designed to power the Ghatak UCAV.
- **Post:** CEMILAC: Centre for Military Airworthiness and Certification is the body responsible for certifying aircraft and engines.
- **Fact:** The KDE achieved a peak dry thrust of 48.5 kN, exceeding the initial target of 46 kN.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of indigenous propulsion technology in achieving 'Atmanirbhar Bharat' in the aerospace and defence sector.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127385

Omar Yaghi and team win Nobel Prize for extracting water in Death Valley

Why in news: Omar Yaghi and his team won the 2025 Nobel Prize in Chemistry for developing Metal-Organic Frameworks (MOFs) capable of extracting liquid water from arid air.

Key facts: The team successfully extracted liquid water from air with 14% humidity in Furnace Creek, Death Valley National Park, between August 19 and 23, 2022. The technology utilizes MOF-303, a material that can capture and release water molecules through adsorption and desorption cycles.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** MOF-303: A Metal-Organic Framework (MOF) used for atmospheric water harvesting.
- **Post:** Omar Yaghi: Saudi national and professor at UC Berkeley, winner of the 2025 Nobel Prize in Chemistry.
- **Place:** Furnace Creek: Located in Death Valley National Park, used as a testing site for water extraction.
- **Fact:** The device successfully extracted water from air with 14% humidity during the 2022 trials.

Mains question: Discuss how advancements in Material Science, specifically Metal-Organic Frameworks (MOFs), can address global water scarcity in arid and semi-arid regions.

Source: Times of India · satyadheesh.in/news/128317

Supreme Court accepts CSIR-NEERI suggestions for limited green cracker relaxations

Why in news: The Supreme Court accepted CSIR-NEERI's technical suggestions to relax green cracker regulations based on noise and emission reduction data.

Key facts: The Supreme Court, led by Justice M.M. Sundresh, reviewed CSIR-NEERI's data showing a 30% reduction in emissions and 45%-60% reduction in particulate matter for green crackers. The crackers must adhere to specific noise limits of 125 dB(AI) and 145 dB(C) while remaining free of banned chemicals.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** CSIR-NEERI: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research - National Environmental Engineering Research Institute
- **Body:** CPCB: Central Pollution Control Board, the statutory organization under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- **Fact:** Green cracker noise limits: 125 dB(AI) and 145 dB(C) peak noise
- **Fact:** Emission reduction: Green crackers show 30% emission reduction and 45%-60% particulate reduction
- **Fact:** Barium testing deadline: CPCB and Union government to continue tests by October 15, 2026

Mains question: Discuss the balance between public safety and environmental preservation in the regulation of firecrackers in India.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128324

IN-SPACe guidelines require Indian entities to seek authorization for hosted-payloads under Space Policy 2023

Why in news: IN-SPACe released guidelines under the Space Policy 2023 requiring Indian entities to seek authorization for hosted-payloads to ensure national security and treaty compliance.

Key facts: IN-SPACe released the guidelines on September 17, 2026. The DPIIT currently lists 440 startups in the space sector, and IN-SPACe has granted 113 authorizations to 52 Non-Government Entities.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** IN-SPACe: Indian National Space Promotion and Authorization Centre, the nodal agency for private sector space activities.
- **Fact:** DPIIT: Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, currently listing 440 space startups.
- **S&T:** Hosted-payloads: Instruments or equipment carried by a spacecraft and operated by a third party.
- **Post:** Space Policy 2023: The overarching framework governing India's commercial space sector.

Mains question: Discuss how the regulatory framework for hosted-payloads balances the promotion of private space exploration with national security and international treaty obligations.

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/128423](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128423)

Environment & Ecology

Researchers at Northumbria University, supported by NASA, found that Greenland and Antarctica

Why in news: A study by Northumbria University and NASA reveals a significant acceleration in ice loss from Greenland and Antarctica since the 1970s, contributing to rising sea levels.

Key facts: The study analyzed 42 satellite surveys over five decades (1979-2023). It found a loss of 11.3 billion tonnes of ice, resulting in a 31.4 mm rise in global sea levels, with glacier acceleration accounting for 84% of the loss.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Greenland ice loss increased from 60 billion to 264 billion tonnes annually between 1979 and 2023
- **Fact:** Antarctica ice loss increased from 48 billion to 202 billion tonnes annually between 1979 and 2023
- **S&T:** Glacier acceleration, rather than surface melting, accounted for 84% of the ice loss
- **Fact:** Total sea level rise attributed to these losses is 31.4 millimeters

Mains question: Discuss the impact of accelerated glacial melting in polar regions on global climate patterns and coastal geography. Suggest measures to mitigate these effects.

Source: Times of India · [satyadheesh.in/news/122648](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/122648)

Uttarakhand's Glaciers Are Melting Rapidly, Study Flags Threats

Why in news: A Discover Geoscience study highlights the rapid melting of 23 major glaciers in Uttarakhand, posing risks to water security and disaster management.

Key facts: The study identifies significant retreat in glaciers like Gangotri, Khatling, and Milam. The Milam glacier specifically recorded a melting rate of 37.8 meters per year due to rising temperatures and geographical factors.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Milam glacier melting rate: 37.8 meters per year
- **Place:** Gangotri, Khatling, and Milam glaciers are located in Uttarakhand
- **Environment:** Glacial retreat is a primary indicator of climate change in the Himalayan region

Mains question: Discuss the impact of Himalayan glacial retreat on India's water security and the increasing frequency of natural disasters in the Himalayan region.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/123636

Delhi bans non-compliant vehicles from November 1 under strict new Winter Action Plan

Why in news: The Delhi government and Ministry of Environment unveiled the Winter Action Plan 2026-27 to mitigate severe air pollution in the National Capital Region (NCR).

Key facts: The plan includes a 'No PUCC, No Fuel' campaign at 500 fuel pumps using ANPR systems. It mandates construction bans and work-from-home policies starting October 1 and November 1, respectively, involving agencies like CAQM and CPCB.

Prelims pointers

- **Body:** CAQM: Commission for Air Quality Management is a statutory body for air pollution management in NCR.
- **Body:** CPCB: Central Pollution Control Board is the statutory authority for pollution control in India.
- **Fact:** ANPR: Automatic Number Plate Recognition systems are used to monitor non-compliant vehicles.
- **Place:** NCR: National Capital Region includes Delhi and surrounding districts of Haryana, UP, and Rajasthan.

Mains question: Discuss the effectiveness of multi-agency collaborative frameworks like the CAQM in tackling the recurring winter air pollution crisis in the National Capital Region.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127829

East and northeast regions record driest monsoon since 1901 at 1,017.1 mm

Why in news: The India Meteorological Department (IMD) reported that the 2026 southwest monsoon was significantly below normal, with the East and Northeast regions recording their driest monsoon since 1901.

Key facts: India's 2026 southwest monsoon recorded 759.4 mm of rain, which is 12.6% below the 868.6 mm normal. The East and Northeast region recorded 1,017.1 mm, the lowest since systematic records began in 1901.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India's 2026 southwest monsoon rainfall was 87% of the Long Period Average (LPA).
- **S&T:** El Nino is identified as a primary driver for the subdued monsoon rainfall in 2026.
- **Body:** The India Meteorological Department (IMD) is the nodal agency for monitoring and forecasting monsoon patterns in India.
- **Fact:** The southern peninsula recorded 542 mm of rain, the fourth lowest monsoon rainfall in that region since 1901.

Mains question: *Analyze the impact of El Nino and climate change on the variability of the Indian monsoon and its implications for food security.*

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128578

Internal Security

Defence Ministry Reports Reduction in Chinese Forces Near India Border

Why in news: The Defence Ministry reported a reduction in Chinese troop presence along the LAC following India's deployment of 10 brigade-sized forces and sustained bilateral diplomatic engagements.

Key facts: India deployed 10 brigade-size forces, each comprising approximately 3,000 soldiers, along the Line of Actual Control (LAC). Stability was reinforced through WMCC meetings, SR talks, and the Prime Minister's visit to China for the SCO Summit in August 2025.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** India deployed 10 brigade-size forces along the LAC.
- **Fact:** Each brigade consists of approximately 3,000 soldiers.
- **Place:** Line of Actual Control (LAC) serves as the de facto border between India and China.
- **Body:** WMCC (Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination) is a bilateral mechanism for border issues.

Mains question: *Discuss the significance of bilateral mechanisms and troop deployment in maintaining peace and stability along the Line of Actual Control (LAC).*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/121577

India declares Shahzad Bhatti Network terrorist organisation under UAPA

Why in news: The Union Home Minister declared the Pakistan-based Shahzad Bhatti Network (SBN) a terrorist organisation under the UAPA to curb arms smuggling and radicalization.

Key facts: The Shahzad Bhatti Network (SBN) is the 46th organisation listed as a terrorist entity by India. The declaration was made via a gazette notification invoking Section 35(1)(a) of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA).

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** UAPA: Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967, provides the legal framework to designate and deal with terrorist organisations.
- **Fact:** Shahzad Bhatti Network (SBN) is the 46th organisation listed as a terrorist entity by the Indian government.
- **S&T:** SBN is accused of publishing hateful digital content and inciting youths into terrorism.

Mains question: Discuss the role of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) in maintaining internal security and countering transnational terrorism in India.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/122479

Jammu and Kashmir Sees Zero Stone-Throwing Incidents, but Ceasefire Violations Spike to 163

Why in news: The Ministry of Defence's 2025-26 Annual Report highlights a significant decline in stone-throwing and local terrorist recruitment in J&K, despite a spike in LoC ceasefire violations.

Key facts: The report notes zero stone-throwing incidents and only one local terrorist recruitment in 2025, down from 146 in 2021. While ceasefire violations spiked to 163 in 2025, they remain significantly lower than 2019-2020 levels.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** Local terrorist recruitment in J&K dropped from 146 in 2021 to 1 in 2025.
- **Fact:** Ceasefire violations on the LoC in 2025 reached 163, a spike from zero in 2023.
- **Fact:** Tourism in J&K reached a record high of 2.3 crore visitors in 2025.
- **Fact:** 124 of the 163 ceasefire violations occurred during Operation Sindoor.

Mains question: Analyze the factors contributing to the declining trend of local radicalization in Jammu and Kashmir despite persistent cross-border ceasefire violations.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/122617

China Claims It Has Cut Troops At The Border. But The Reality Is More Complex

Why in news: The Indian Ministry of Defence released its Annual Report for 2025-26, detailing the deployment status of the PLA Western Theatre Command along the Line of Actual Control (LAC).

Key facts: The Indian Ministry of Defence reported that the PLA Western Theatre Command (WTC) has deployed approximately 10 Combined Arms Brigade-sized forces along the LAC. The reported troop strength in these areas ranges between 90,000 and 120,000 personnel.

Prelims pointers

- **Fact:** PLA Western Theatre Command (WTC) is the military command responsible for China's western front including the border with India.
- **Fact:** The Indian Ministry of Defence released the Annual Report for 2025-26 regarding border troop deployments.
- **Place:** Line of Actual Control (LAC) serves as the de facto border between India and China.

Mains question: *Analyze the implications of shifting troop deployments along the Line of Actual Control on India's strategic security and regional stability.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/125223

Supreme Court takes action on Delhi's gang-rape cases, echoes 2012 Nirbhaya failures

Why in news: The Supreme Court took suo motu cognizance of recent gang-rape cases in Delhi to address systemic law enforcement failures and public safety lapses.

Key facts: The Supreme Court, led by Justice JB Pardiwala, initiated action on recent rape cases including a minor's gang-rape on a sleeper bus. The court drew parallels to the 2012 Nirbhaya case, highlighting recurring failures in police accountability and public safety infrastructure.

Prelims pointers

- **Post:** Justice JB Pardiwala: Presiding judge in the Supreme Court's suo motu cognizance of Delhi rape cases.
- **Fact:** 2012 Nirbhaya Case: A landmark case in India that led to significant legal reforms and the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013.
- **Body:** Suo Motu Cognizance: The power of the Supreme Court to take up a matter on its own motion without a formal petition.

Mains question: *Critically analyze the systemic challenges in law enforcement and public safety infrastructure in urban centers, and suggest measures to ensure victim safety and police accountability.*

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/126958

RK Singh, India's Defence Secretary, stated at NDTV's Defence Conclave 2026 that the government

Why in news: Defence Secretary RK Singh announced the fast-tracking of a limited batch of Zorawar light tanks to counter China's Type-15 tanks along the LAC.

Key facts: The Zorawar light tank was developed jointly by DRDO's CVRDE and Larsen & Toubro (L&T) since March 2022. The government plans to induct an initial batch of 18 tanks (out of 59 ordered) with lower protection levels to ensure continuous manufacturing while meeting army requirements.

Prelims pointers

- **S&T:** Zorawar: A light tank developed jointly by DRDO (CVRDE) and Larsen & Toubro (L&T).
- **Fact:** The first batch of Zorawar tanks to be inducted consists of 18 units out of a total order of 59.
- **Place:** The Zorawar tanks are specifically intended for use along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) in Ladakh.
- **S&T:** Type-15: A light tank used by China, which the Zorawar is intended to counter.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of indigenous defense manufacturing and 'incremental induction' in strengthening India's border security against high-altitude threats.

Source: NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/127128

Shah Unveils PRAHAAR Strategy, Busting 40 Modules Linked to Bhatti Network

Why in news: Home Minister Amit Shah announced the 'PRAHAAR' strategy and the dismantling of the Shahzad Bhatti network, highlighting a shift toward multi-agency coordination in counter-terrorism.

Key facts: The government busted over 40 modules linked to the Shahzad Bhatti network, resulting in 350 arrests and 100+ FIRs across 15 states. The network was declared a terrorist organization under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA).

Prelims pointers

- **Act / Bill:** UAPA: Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act provides the legal framework for designating and prosecuting terrorist organizations.
- **Fact:** The operation involved 350 arrests and over 100 FIRs across 15 Indian states.
- **Body:** Extradition Portal: A new government initiative launched to expedite the return of fugitives from foreign countries.

Mains question: Discuss the significance of multi-agency coordination and legislative frameworks like UAPA in strengthening India's counter-terrorism architecture.

Source: The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/127298

Half of Indian cybercrime victims complain to police, 27% pay bribes

Why in news: The Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026 highlights systemic corruption and informal reliance among cybercrime victims, revealing that 27% of victims pay bribes to ensure case processing.

Key facts: The SPIR 2026 report by Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause found that while 50% of cybercrime victims report to police, 27% pay bribes. Bribes correlate with a jump in recovery rates from 12% to 41%, while 37% of victims rely on personal networks.

Prelims pointers

- **Report / Index:** SPIR 2026: Status of Policing in India Report published by Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause
- **Fact:** 27% of cybercrime victims report paying bribes for case handling
- **Fact:** Recovery rates increase from 12% to 41% when bribes are paid
- **Fact:** Rural poor (51%) and women (35%) are more likely to pay bribes than urban affluent (12%)

Mains question: *Discuss the challenges in policing cybercrimes in India, with special reference to the role of corruption and the reliance on informal networks by vulnerable sections.*

Source: The Hindu · [satyadheesh.in/news/128130](https://www.satyadheesh.in/news/128130)

Practice — Mains questions

1. Discuss the significance of the 'Global South' concept in contemporary multilateralism and India's role in shaping the agenda of the BRICS bloc. · GS2
2. Discuss the significance of BRICS as a platform for reshaping the global order and its role in promoting a multipolar world. · GS2
3. Discuss the significance of achieving imaging capabilities in Geosynchronous orbit for India's space-based surveillance and disaster management capabilities. · GS3
4. Discuss the significance of BRICS in elevating the influence of the Global South and its role in reshaping the current global economic order. · GS2
5. Discuss the challenges in balancing the protection of children under the POCSO Act with the prevention of its misuse in matrimonial disputes. · GS2
6. Discuss the significance of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) in formalizing India's digital economy and the challenges of sustaining its infrastructure through transaction fees. · GS3
7. Discuss the significance of BRICS in shaping a multipolar world order and its role in fostering South-South cooperation in global trade. · GS2
8. Discuss the significance of BRICS as a platform for the Global South to advocate for multilateralism and reform of the global economic order. · GS2
9. Analyze the impact of the escalating US-Iran tensions on global energy security and maritime trade routes in the Middle East. · GS2
10. Discuss the significance of the US-China relationship in shaping global trade and technological standards, particularly in the realm of Artificial Intelligence. · GS2
11. Discuss the implications of unilateral US sanctions on global energy trade and the challenges it poses for the economic interests of emerging economies like India. · GS2
12. Discuss the shifting dynamics of global economic governance as BRICS emerges as a significant counterweight to the G7's traditional economic leadership. · GS2
13. Discuss the significance of BRICS in shaping the global multi-polar order and India's strategic role within the bloc. · GS2
14. Discuss the significance of the IAEA's role in ensuring global nuclear non-proliferation and the implications of non-compliance on regional and global security. · GS2
15. Analyze the geopolitical and economic implications of maritime instability in the Strait of Hormuz on global energy security and international trade routes. · GS2
16. Discuss the role of third-party mediation in resolving protracted geopolitical conflicts and its impact on global security architecture. · GS2
17. Discuss the significance of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) in creating an alternative economic and security architecture for the Global South. · GS2
18. Discuss the significance of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) in shaping India's strategic autonomy and security cooperation in Central Asia. · GS2
19. Critically examine the role of Minimum Support Price (MSP) in ensuring food security and farmer welfare while addressing the fiscal implications on the national exchequer. · GS3
20. Critically examine the Collegium system of judicial appointments in India. Does it ensure transparency and accountability in the higher judiciary? · GS2

21. Discuss India's growing role as a voice for the Global South in advocating for a multi-polar world order and reformed multilateralism at the United Nations. · GS2
22. Discuss how regulatory measures on insurance commissions and bundling can balance consumer protection with the growth of insurance penetration in rural India. · GS3
23. Discuss the challenges in establishing a global regulatory framework for Artificial Intelligence amidst geopolitical competition and technological sovereignty. · GS3
24. Analyze the factors contributing to India's robust economic growth and discuss the potential risks posed by climate-related variables on the manufacturing and agricultural sectors. · GS3
25. Analyze the impact of the Taiwan issue on the evolving dynamics of India-China-US trilateral relations and global maritime security. · GS2
26. Discuss the significance of India's growing strategic partnerships with the Visegrad Group in the context of its bid for a permanent seat in the UN Security Council. · GS2
27. Analyze the role of regional powers like Qatar in mediating Middle Eastern conflicts and the impact of economic sanctions on regional stability. · GS2
28. Discuss the significance of developing a robust semiconductor manufacturing ecosystem for India's economic sovereignty and technological advancement. · GS3
29. Discuss the implications of imposing Merchant Discount Rates (MDR) on digital payment systems for the growth of the formal economy and small businesses in India. · GS3
30. Discuss the significance of expanding social security coverage for the unorganized and formal workforce in India's quest for inclusive growth. · GS3

Prelims quick revision

- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Fact:** The Delhi Declaration was the primary outcome of the summit, focusing on global governance and security.
- **Place:** The summit took place in Delhi, India.
- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (expanded to include new members).
- **Fact:** The summit featured leaders from Iran and the UAE, reflecting the bloc's expanding geopolitical reach.
- **Place:** Delhi, India: Host city for the recent BRICS summit.
- **S&T:** EOS-05: India's first imaging satellite in Geosynchronous orbit
- **S&T:** GSLV: Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle, a heavy-lift rocket developed by ISRO
- **Place:** Satish Dhawan Space Centre: Located in Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh (near Chennai)
- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Fact:** The current summit includes representatives from 11 member nations.
- **Place:** New Delhi, India: Host city for the BRICS summit.
- **Act / Bill:** POCSO Act: Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012
- **Body:** Supreme Court: Highest judicial body in India, headed by the Chief Justice of India

- **Fact:** The ruling emphasizes the need for expert psychological/psychiatric evaluations before arrest
- **Fact:** UPI handled 24,162 crore transactions in FY26.
- **Fact:** P2M transactions above ₹2,000 account for 66% of the total UPI transaction value.
- **Fact:** The new MDR is 0.4% for P2M transactions over ₹2,000, capped at ₹300.
- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Fact:** The summit in Delhi involves 11 participating nations.
- **Post:** Narendra Modi: Prime Minister of India; Xi Jinping: President of China; Vladimir Putin: President of Russia.
- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (plus new members).
- **Fact:** The New Delhi Summit focused on multilateral trade and opposition to protectionism.
- **S&T:** AI cooperation was proposed as a key pillar for new industrialization within the BRICS framework.
- **Place:** Strait of Hormuz: A strategic chokepoint in the Middle East connecting the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman.
- **Fact:** The Iranian Red Crescent reported 4 fatalities in a southern Iran missile strike.
- **S&T:** The conflict involves the deployment of both missiles and drones as primary offensive weapons.
- **Place:** Joint Base Andrews: A major US military installation in Maryland used for receiving heads of state.
- **Fact:** The visit marks the first such welcome since 1962.
- **S&T:** AI (Artificial Intelligence) and trade tariffs are primary pillars of the US-China bilateral agenda.
- **Fact:** The Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia Act of 2026 proposes tariffs up to 100% on top Russian energy purchasers.
- **Fact:** The bill proposes up to 500% tariffs on Russian imports directly into the United States.
- **Place:** The act specifically targets major buyers of Russian crude, including China and India.
- **Fact:** BRICS contribution to global GDP: >40%
- **Fact:** G7 contribution to global GDP: 29%
- **Fact:** Current BRICS membership: 21 members
- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (expanded in 2024).
- **Place:** New Delhi: Host city for the 18th BRICS Summit in 2026.
- **Fact:** The summit is scheduled for September 12-13, 2026.
- **Intl. org:** IAEA: International Atomic Energy Agency, responsible for nuclear safeguards and monitoring.
- **Intl. org:** UNSC: United Nations Security Council, the body to which the IAEA referred the Iran noncompliance matter.

- **Fact:** NPT: Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty, a multilateral treaty aimed at preventing the spread of nuclear weapons.
- **Place:** Strait of Hormuz: A strategic chokepoint connecting the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea.
- **Fact:** The Strait of Hormuz is a primary transit point for a significant portion of the world's oil and liquefied natural gas (LNG).
- **Intl. org:** UN Security Council: The body responsible for maintaining international peace and security, where Iran may be referred regarding nuclear issues.
- **Place:** Kyiv: Capital of Ukraine
- **Fact:** Russia-Ukraine war has lasted for over four years
- **Place:** Rzeszow: Polish city used as a transit point for the envoys
- **Intl. org:** SCO: Shanghai Cooperation Organisation includes China, India, Russia, Iran, and Central Asian states.
- **Fact:** SCO projected to hold 34.3% of global GDP in PPP terms by 2026.
- **Post:** Vladimir Putin: President of Russia; Narendra Modi: Prime Minister of India.
- **Intl. org:** SCO: Shanghai Cooperation Organisation is a Eurasian political, economic, and security alliance.
- **Place:** Bishkek is the capital of Kyrgyzstan.
- **Fact:** SCO members include China, Russia, India, Pakistan, and Central Asian nations.
- **Fact:** Wheat MSP for 2027-28 rabi marketing year: ₹2,610 per quintal
- **Fact:** Masur MSP for 2027-28 rabi marketing year: ₹7,390 per quintal
- **Body:** CACP (Commission for Agricultural Costs & Prices) provides recommendations for MSP fixing
- **Body:** The Collegium system is the mechanism used by the Supreme Court of India to recommend names for judgeships.
- **Post:** The Collegium currently comprises the Chief Justice of India and four other senior-most judges.
- **Fact:** The three recommended judges represent the Gujarat, Delhi, and Telangana High Courts.
- **Post:** S. Jaishankar: Minister of External Affairs, Government of India
- **Body:** UNGA: United Nations General Assembly, the main policy-making body of the UN
- **Fact:** The 'Four Fs' impacted by global conflicts: Food, Fuel, Fertilizers, and Finance
- **Body:** IRDAI: The statutory body regulating the insurance sector in India
- **Fact:** Proposed measures include caps on commissions and lower expense limits for insurers
- **Fact:** Bundling of insurance with loans is a key area of proposed restriction
- **S&T:** OpenAI and Anthropic are leading private companies in the development of Generative AI and Large Language Models (LLMs).
- **Intl. org:** The UN General Assembly passed its first resolution on AI in 2024.
- **Fact:** The UN Security Council meeting on AI was convened by France.
- **Fact:** S&P Global Ratings projected India's GDP growth at 7% for the current fiscal year.
- **Fact:** RBI is projected to hike interest rates by 25 basis points in FY27.

- **Fact:** S&P estimates consumer inflation at 5.1%.
- **Fact:** Proposed US arms package for Taiwan: USD 11 billion
- **Place:** Taiwan: A territory claimed by China, currently a self-governing entity.
- **S&T:** Fentanyl: A potent synthetic opioid whose production chemicals are a point of bilateral negotiation.
- **Body:** Visegrad Group (V4): An intergovernmental organization consisting of Poland, Hungary, Slovakia, and the Czech Republic.
- **Body:** UNSC: The United Nations Security Council is the primary organ responsible for maintaining international peace and security.
- **Fact:** The meeting took place on the margins of the 81st session of the UN General Assembly.
- **Fact:** Iran's peace demands include the release of frozen assets and lifting of the US naval blockade.
- **Place:** Qatar is acting as a mediator in the peace negotiations between Iran and the US.
- **Post:** Mohsen Rezaei is identified as Iran's top security official.
- **Fact:** Kaynes Technology is investing ₹3,307 crore in a semiconductor facility in Gujarat.
- **S&T:** Semicon India 2026 showcases the full semiconductor value chain including design and systems.
- **Fact:** Stock gains at Semicon India 2026: Syrma SGS Technology (10%), MosChip Technologies (6%), and Kaynes Technology (5%).
- **Act / Bill:** Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007: Governs the framework for electronic payment systems in India.
- **Fact:** The proposed MDR (Merchant Discount Rate) is 0.4% for UPI transactions exceeding ₹2,000.
- **Body:** UPI (Unified Payments Interface): A real-time payment system developed by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI).
- **Fact:** New EPFO wage ceiling: ₹25,000
- **Fact:** Additional workers covered: 51 lakh
- **Fact:** Annual government outgo increase: ₹11,339 crore
- **S&T:** Kinetic systems and jammers are primary types of counterspace weapons.
- **Fact:** India successfully demonstrated ASAT (Anti-Satellite) capability in 2019.
- **S&T:** Space Situational Awareness (SSA) involves monitoring the positions and activities of objects in space.
- **Intl. org:** BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- **Fact:** Egypt joined BRICS as a full member in January 2024.
- **Place:** New Delhi: Venue of the 18th BRICS Summit.
- **Fact:** BRICS global GDP share: 41% (surpassing G7's 28%)
- **Fact:** India's trade dynamics: BRICS countries to account for 22% of exports and 41% of imports by 2026
- **Place:** 18th BRICS Summit: To be hosted in New Delhi, India (September 12-13)

- **Place:** Gulf of Oman: Region where the M/T Riesco was sunk.
- **Place:** Kharg Island: Major Iranian oil terminal and export hub.
- **Fact:** Brent crude rose by 1.5% to \$99.35 following the escalation.
- **Place:** Kolkata and New Jalpaiguri are major railway hubs in West Bengal, India.
- **Fact:** Three cross-border trains are slated for resumption between India and Bangladesh.
- **Body:** The Inter-Governmental Railway Meeting is the annual bilateral forum for rail connectivity.
- **Place:** Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin are territories currently under dispute between India and China.
- **Place:** The Line of Control (LoC) is the de facto border between India and Pakistan in Jammu and Kashmir.
- **Fact:** The UN map was released on July 1 following an African Union-backed resolution.
- **Place:** Bishkek is the capital of Kyrgyzstan
- **Place:** Chabahar Port is a strategic maritime port in Iran
- **Body:** BRICS is a multilateral grouping including Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa
- **Place:** Gulf of Oman: A strategic maritime waterway and key transit point for oil shipments.
- **Body:** IRGC: Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, an elite branch of the Iranian Armed Forces.
- **Body:** CENTCOM: United States Central Command, responsible for US military operations in the Middle East.
- **Post:** Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner: US envoys sent to negotiate peace in Ukraine.
- **Fact:** The Russia-Ukraine conflict has been ongoing for approximately four and a half years.
- **Place:** Kyiv: Capital of Ukraine, currently the site of the proposed peace talks.
- **Body:** UNICEF: United Nations Children's Fund, a UN agency responsible for providing humanitarian and developmental assistance to children.
- **Fact:** Over one in five children aged 12 to 17 were affected by online sexual exploitation in the studied regions.
- **S&T:** AI-generated sexual content is identified as a growing threat to child safety in digital spaces.
- **Fact:** India's 2026 southwest monsoon rainfall was 87% of the Long Period Average (LPA).
- **S&T:** El Nino is identified as a primary driver for the subdued monsoon rainfall in 2026.
- **Body:** The India Meteorological Department (IMD) is the nodal agency for monitoring and forecasting monsoon patterns in India.
- **Body:** Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: The overarching framework for India-US bilateral relations.
- **Post:** Narendra Modi: Prime Minister of India.
- **Post:** Donald Trump: President of the United States.
- **Body:** IN-SPACe: Indian National Space Promotion and Authorization Centre, the nodal agency for private sector space activities.
- **Fact:** DPIIT: Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, currently listing 440 space startups.

- **S&T:** Hosted-payloads: Instruments or equipment carried by a spacecraft and operated by a third party.
- **Fact:** The US paused a USD 14 billion arms package for Taiwan as a bargaining chip during negotiations with China.
- **Fact:** The US and China extended their trade truce by two months following the Washington summit.
- **Place:** Donald Trump is scheduled to visit China for the APEC summit in November 2025.
- **Fact:** Total outlay for Green Energy Corridor Phase-III: ₹1,86,405 crore
- **Fact:** Target for renewable energy evacuation: 135 GW by FY 2032-33
- **Fact:** Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) target: 50 GWh
- **Fact:** India's current Total Fertility Rate (TFR) is 1.9.
- **Fact:** India is projected to become 'super-aged' by the year 2065.
- **Fact:** Annual births in India have dropped to 2.32 crore.
- **Body:** CSIR-NEERI: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research - National Environmental Engineering Research Institute
- **Body:** CPCB: Central Pollution Control Board, the statutory organization under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- **Fact:** Green cracker noise limits: 125 dB(AI) and 145 dB(C) peak noise
- **S&T:** MOF-303: A Metal-Organic Framework (MOF) used for atmospheric water harvesting.
- **Post:** Omar Yaghi: Saudi national and professor at UC Berkeley, winner of the 2025 Nobel Prize in Chemistry.
- **Place:** Furnace Creek: Located in Death Valley National Park, used as a testing site for water extraction.
- **Fact:** CAFE-3 fuel benchmark: 3.3273 litres per 100 km by 2031–32
- **Fact:** Reference weight increase: From 1,082 kg to 1,229 kg under CAFE-3
- **S&T:** Carbon Neutrality Factor (CNF): A mechanism providing concessions for eligible cleaner technologies
- **Constitution:** Article 19(1)(a): Guarantees freedom of speech and expression, including freedom of the press.
- **Constitution:** Article 194(3): Relates to the privileges of the House of the Legislature of a State.
- **Body:** Supreme Court: The highest judicial body in India, empowered to adjudicate on the constitutionality of legislative actions.
- **Act / Bill:** Representation of the People Act, 1950: Governs the preparation and maintenance of electoral rolls.
- **Constitution:** Article 361: Provides immunity to the President and Governors; the petition argues CEC should not have similar immunity.
- **Body:** Election Commission of India (ECI): Constitutional body responsible for administering elections.
- **Fact:** India's current solar module manufacturing capacity exceeds 213 GW.
- **Fact:** Target for domestic polysilicon production is 30 GW by 2030.

- **Body:** Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) is the nodal ministry for solar incentives.
- **Report / Index:** SPIR 2026: Status of Policing in India Report published by Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause
- **Fact:** 27% of cybercrime victims report paying bribes for case handling
- **Fact:** Recovery rates increase from 12% to 41% when bribes are paid
- **Body:** UNESCO: United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

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